

# Odes and Secular Hymn

Q. HORATII FLACCI CARMINA ET CARMEN SAECULARE

Horace

*translated by John Conington (1863)*

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## Book I

### I. Maecenas atavis edite regibus

1.1

Maecenas, born of monarch ancestors,  
The shield at once and glory of my life!  
There are who joy them in the Olympic strife  
And love the dust they gather in the course;

The goal by hot wheels shunn'd, the famous prize,  
Exalt them to the gods that rule mankind;  
This joys, if rabbles fickle as the wind  
Through triple grade of honours bid him rise,

That, if his granary has stored away  
Of Libya's thousand floors the yield entire;  
The man who digs his field as did his sire,  
With honest pride, no Attalus may sway

By proffer'd wealth to tempt Myrtoan seas,  
The timorous captain of a Cyprian bark.  
The winds that make Icarian billows dark  
The merchant fears, and hugs the rural ease

Of his own village home; but soon, ashamed  
Of penury, he refits his batter'd craft.  
There is, who thinks no scorn of Massic draught,  
Who robs the daylight of an hour unblamed,

Now stretch'd beneath the arbut on the sward,  
 Now by some gentle river's sacred spring;  
 Some love the camp, the clarion's joyous ring,  
 And battle, by the mother's soul abhorr'd.

See, patient waiting in the clear keen air,  
 The hunter, thoughtless of his delicate bride,  
 Whether the trusty hounds a stag have eyed,  
 Or the fierce Marsian boar has burst the snare.

To me the artist's meed, the ivy wreath  
 Is very heaven: me the sweet cool of woods,  
 Where Satyrs frolic with the Nymphs, secludes  
 From rabble rout, so but Euterpe's breath

Fail not the flute, nor Polyhymnia fly  
 Averse from stringing new the Lesbian lyre.  
 O, write my name among that minstrel choir,  
 And my proud head shall strike upon the sky!

## II. Iam satis terris nivis atque dirae

1.2

Enough of snow and hail at last  
 The sire has sent in vengeance down:  
 His bolts, at his own temple cast,  
 Appall'd the town,

Appall'd the lands, lest Pyrrha's time  
 Return, with all its monstrous sights,  
 When Proteus led his flocks to climb  
 The flatten'd heights,

When fish were in the elm-tops caught,

Where once the stock-dove wont to bide,  
And does were floating, all distraught,  
Adown the tide.

Old Tiber, hurl'd in tumult back  
From mingling with the Etruscan main,  
Has threaten'd Numa's court with wrack  
And Vesta's fane.

Roused by his Ilia's plaintive woes,  
He vows revenge for guiltless blood,  
And, spite of Jove, his banks o'erflows,  
Uxorious flood.

Yes, Fame shall tell of civic steel  
That better Persian lives had spilt,  
To youths, whose minish'd numbers feel  
Their parents' guilt.

What god shall Rome invoke to stay  
Her fall? Can suppliance overbear  
The ear of Vesta, turn'd away  
From chant and prayer?

Who comes, commission'd to atone  
For crime like ours? at length appear,  
A cloud round thy bright shoulders thrown,  
Apollo seer!

Or Venus, laughter-loving dame,  
Round whom gay Loves and Pleasures fly;  
Or thou, if slighted sons may claim  
A parent's eye,

O weary with thy long, long game,  
Who lov'st fierce shouts and helmets bright,  
And Moorish warrior's glance of flame  
Or e'er he smite!

Or Maia's son, if now awhile  
In youthful guise we see thee here,  
Caesar's avenger—such the style  
Thou deign'st to bear;

Late be thy journey home, and long  
Thy sojourn with Rome's family;  
Nor let thy wrath at our great wrong  
Lend wings to fly.

Here take our homage, Chief and Sire;  
Here wreath with bay thy conquering brow,  
And bid the prancing Medea retire,  
Our Caesar thou!

### III. Sic te diva potens Cypri

1.3

Thus may Cyprus' heavenly queen,  
Thus Helen's brethren, stars of brightest sheen,  
Guide thee! May the sire of wind  
Each truant gale, save only Zephyr, bind!  
So do thou, fair ship, that ow'st  
Virgil, thy precious freight, to Attic coast,  
Safe restore thy loan and whole,  
And save from death the partner of my soul!  
Oak and brass of triple fold  
Encompass'd sure that heart, which first made bold

To the raging sea to trust  
A fragile bark, nor fear'd the Afric gust  
With its Northern mates at strife,  
Nor Hyads' frown, nor South-wind fury-rife,  
Mightiest power that Hadria knows,  
Wills he the waves to madden or compose.  
What had Death in store to awe  
Those eyes, that huge sea-beasts unmelting saw,  
Saw the swelling of the surge,  
And high Ceraunian cliffs, the seaman's scourge?  
Heaven's high providence in vain  
Has sever'd countries with the estranging main,  
If our vessels ne'ertheless  
With reckless plunge that sacred bar transgress.  
Daring all, their goal to win,  
Men tread forbidden ground, and rush on sin:  
Daring all, Prometheus play'd  
His wily game, and fire to man convey'd;  
Soon as fire was stolen away,  
Pale Fever's stranger host and wan Decay  
Swept o'er earth's polluted face,  
And slow Fate quicken'd Death's once halting pace.  
Daedalus the void air tried  
On wings, to humankind by Heaven denied;  
Acheron's bar gave way with ease  
Before the arm of labouring Hercules.  
Nought is there for man too high;  
Our impious folly e'en would climb the sky,  
Braves the dweller on the steep,  
Nor lets the bolts of heavenly vengeance sleep.

#### IV. Solvitur acris hiems grata vice veris et Favoni

The touch of Zephyr and of Spring has loosen'd Winter's thrall;  
 The well-dried keels are wheel'd again to sea:  
 The ploughman cares not for his fire, nor cattle for their stall,  
 And frost no more is whitening all the lea.  
 Now Cytherea leads the dance, the bright moon overhead;  
 The Graces and the Nymphs, together knit,  
 With rhythmic feet the meadow beat, while Vulcan, fiery red,  
 Heats the Cyclopien forge in Aetna's pit.  
 'Tis now the time to wreath the brow with branch of myrtle green,  
 Or flowers, just opening to the vernal breeze;  
 Now Faunus claims his sacrifice among the shady treen,  
 Lambkin or kidling, which soe'er he please.  
 Pale Death, impartial, walks his round: he knocks at cottage-gate  
 And palace-portal. Sestius, child of bliss!  
 How should a mortal's hopes be long, when short his being's date?  
 Lo here! the fabulous ghosts, the dark abyss,  
 The void of the Plutonian hall, where soon as e'er you go,  
 No more for you shall leap the auspicious die  
 To seat you on the throne of wine; no more your breast shall glow  
 For Lycidas, the star of every eye.

### V. Quis multa gracilis te puer in rosa

1.5

What slender youth, besprinkled with perfume,  
 Courts you on roses in some grotto's shade?  
 Fair Pyrrha, say, for whom  
 Your yellow hair you braid,

So trim, so simple! Ah! how oft shall he  
 Lament that faith can fail, that gods can change,  
 Viewing the rough black sea  
 With eyes to tempests strange,

Who now is basking in your golden smile,  
And dreams of you still fancy-free, still kind,  
Poor fool, nor knows the guile  
Of the deceitful wind!

Woe to the eyes you dazzle without cloud  
Untried! For me, they show in yonder fane  
My dripping garments, vow'd  
To Him who curbs the main.

## VI. Scriberis Vario fortis et hostium

1.6

Not I, but Varius:—he, of Homer's brood  
A tuneful swan, shall bear you on his wing,  
Your tale of trophies, won by field or flood,  
Mighty alike to sing.

Not mine such themes, Agrippa; no, nor mine  
To chant the Wrath that fill'd Pelides' breast,  
Nor dark Ulysses' wanderings o'er the brine,  
Nor Pelops' house unblest.

Vast were the task, I feeble; inborn shame,  
And she, who makes the peaceful lyre submit,  
Forbid me to impair great Caesar's fame  
And yours by my weak wit.

But who may fitly sing of Mars array'd  
In adamant mail, or Merion, black with dust  
Of Troy, or Tydeus' son by Pallas' aid  
Strong against gods to thrust?

Feasts are my theme, my warriors maidens fair,

Who with pared nails encounter youths in fight;  
Be Fancy free or caught in Cupid's snare,  
Her temper still is light.

## VII. Laudabunt alii claram Rhodon aut Mytilenen

1.7

Let others Rhodes or Mytilene sing,  
Or Ephesus, or Corinth, set between  
Two seas, or Thebes, or Delphi, for its king  
Each famous, or Thessalian Tempe green;  
There are who make chaste Pallas' virgin tower  
The daily burden of unending song,  
And search for wreaths the olive's rifled bower:  
The praise of Juno sounds from many a tongue,  
Telling of Argos' steeds, Mycenae's gold.  
For me stern Sparta forges no such spell,  
No, nor Larissa's plain of richest mould,  
As bright Albunea echoing from her cell.  
O headlong Anio! O Tiburnian groves,  
And orchards saturate with shifting streams!  
Look how the clear fresh south from heaven removes  
The tempest, nor with rain perpetual teems!  
You too be wise, my Plancus: life's worst cloud  
Will melt in air, by mellow wine allay'd,  
Dwell you in camps, with glittering banners proud,  
Or 'neath your Tibur's canopy of shade.  
When Teucer fled before his father's frown  
From Salamis, they say his temples deep  
He dipp'd in wine, then wreath'd with poplar crown,  
And bade his comrades lay their grief to sleep:  
"Where Fortune bears us, than my sire more kind,  
There let us go, my own, my gallant crew.  
'Tis Teucer leads, 'tis Teucer breathes the wind;

No more despair; Apollo's word is true.  
 Another Salamis in kindlier air  
 Shall yet arise. Hearts, that have borne with me  
 Worse buffets! drown to-day in wine your care;  
 To-morrow we recross the wide, wide sea!"

### VIII. Lydia, dic per omnis

1.8

Lydia, by all above,  
 Why bear so hard on Sybaris, to ruin him with love?  
 What change has made him shun  
 The playing-ground, who once so well could bear the dust and sun?  
 Why does he never sit  
 On horseback in his company, nor with uneven bit  
 His Gallic courser tame?  
 Why dreads he yellow Tiber, as 'twould sully that fair frame?  
 Like poison loathes the oil,  
 His arms no longer black and blue with honourable toil,  
 He who erewhile was known  
 For quoit or javelin oft and oft beyond the limit thrown?  
 Why skulks he, as they say  
 Did Thetis' son before the dawn of Ilion's fatal day,  
 For fear the manly dress  
 Should fling him into danger's arms, amid the Lycian press?

### IX. Vides ut alta stet nive candidum

1.9

See, how it stands, one pile of snow,  
 Soracte! 'neath the pressure yield  
 Its groaning woods; the torrents' flow  
 With clear sharp ice is all congeal'd.  
 Heap high the logs, and melt the cold,  
 Good Thaliarch; draw the wine we ask,

That mellower vintage, four-year-old,  
From out the cellar'd Sabine cask.  
The future trust with Jove; when he  
Has still'd the warring tempests' roar  
On the vex'd deep, the cypress-tree  
And aged ash are rock'd no more.  
O, ask not what the morn will bring,  
But count as gain each day that chance  
May give you; sport in life's young spring,  
Nor scorn sweet love, nor merry dance,  
While years are green, while sullen eld  
Is distant. Now the walk, the game,  
The whisper'd talk at sunset held,  
Each in its hour, prefer their claim.  
Sweet too the laugh, whose feign'd alarm  
The hiding-place of beauty tells,  
The token, ravish'd from the arm  
Or finger, that but ill rebels.

#### X. Mercuri facunde nepos Atlantis

1.10

Grandson of Atlas, wise of tongue,  
O Mercury, whose wit could tame  
Man's savage youth by power of song  
And plastic game!

Thee sing I, herald of the sky,  
Who gav'st the lyre its music sweet,  
Hiding whate'er might please thine eye  
In frolic cheat.

See, threatening thee, poor guileless child,  
Apollo claims, in angry tone,

His cattle;—all at once he smiled,  
His quiver gone.

Strong in thy guidance, Hector's sire  
Escaped the Atridae, pass'd between  
Thessalian tents and warders' fire,  
Of all unseen.

Thou lay'st unspotted souls to rest;  
Thy golden rod pale spectres know;  
Blest power! by all thy brethren blest,  
Above, below!

XI. Tu ne quaesieris, scire nefas, quem mihi, quem tibi

1.11

Ask not ('tis forbidden knowledge), what our destined term of years,  
Mine and yours; nor scan the tables of your Babylonish seers.  
Better far to bear the future, my Leuconoe, like the past,  
Whether Jove has many winters yet to give, or this our last;  
*This*, that makes the Tyrrhene billows spend their strength against the  
shore.  
Strain your wine and prove your wisdom; life is short; should hope be  
more?  
In the moment of our talking, envious time has ebb'd away.  
Seize the present; trust to-morrow e'en as little as you may.

XII. Quem virum aut heroa lyra vel acri

1.12

What man, what hero, Clio sweet,  
On harp or flute wilt thou proclaim?  
What god shall echo's voice repeat  
In mocking game

To Helicon's sequester'd shade,  
Or Pindus, or on Haemus chill,  
Where once the hurrying woods obey'd  
The minstrel's will,

Who, by his mother's gift of song,  
Held the fleet stream, the rapid breeze,  
And led with blandishment along  
The listening trees?

Whom praise we first? the sire on high,  
Who gods and men unerring guides,  
Who rules the sea, the earth, the sky,  
Their times and tides.

No mightier birth may he beget;  
No like, no second has he known;  
Yet nearest to her sire's is set  
Minerva's throne.

Nor yet shall Bacchus pass unsaid,  
Bold warrior, nor the virgin foe  
Of savage beasts, nor Phoebus, dread  
With deadly bow.

Alcides too shall be my theme,  
And Leda's twins, for horses he,  
He famed for boxing; soon as gleam  
Their stars at sea,

The lash'd spray trickles from the steep,  
The wind sinks down, the storm-cloud flies,  
The threatening billow on the deep

Obedient lies.

Shall now Quirinus take his turn,  
Or quiet Numa, or the state  
Proud Tarquin held, or Cato stern,  
By death made great?

Ay, Regulus and the Scaurian name,  
And Paullus, who at Cannae gave  
His glorious soul, fair record claim,  
For all were brave.

Thee, Furius, and Fabricius, thee,  
Rough Curius too, with untrimm'd beard,  
Your sires' transmitted poverty  
To conquest rear'd.

Marcellus' fame, its up-growth hid,  
Springs like a tree; great Julius' light  
Shines, like the radiant moon amid  
The lamps of night.

Dread Sire and Guardian of man's race,  
To thee, O Jove, the Fates assign  
Our Caesar's charge; his power and place  
Be next to thine.

Whether the Parthian, threatening Rome,  
His eagles scatter to the wind,  
Or follow to their eastern home  
Cathay and Ind,

Thy second let him rule below:

Thy car shall shake the realms above;  
Thy vengeful bolts shall overthrow  
Each guilty grove.

XIII. Cum tu, Lydia, Telephi

1.13

Telephus—you praise him still,  
His waxen arms, his rosy-tinted neck;  
Ah! and all the while I thrill  
With jealous pangs I cannot, cannot check.  
See, my colour comes and goes,  
My poor heart flutters, Lydia, and the dew,  
Down my cheek soft stealing, shows  
What lingering torments rack me through and through.  
Oh, 'tis agony to see  
Those snowwhite shoulders scarr'd in drunken fray,  
Or those ruby lips, where he  
Has left strange marks, that show how rough his play!  
Never, never look to find  
A faithful heart in him whose rage can harm  
Sweetest lips, which Venus kind  
Has tintured with her quintessential charm.  
Happy, happy, happy they  
Whose living love, untroubled by all strife,  
Binds them till the last sad day,  
Nor parts asunder but with parting life!

XIV. O navis, referent in mare te novi

1.14

O luckless bark! new waves will force you back  
To sea. O, haste to make the haven yours!  
E'en now, a helpless wrack,  
You drift, despoil'd of oars;

The Afric gale has dealt your mast a wound;  
Your sailyards groan, nor can your keel sustain,  
Till lash'd with cables round,  
A more imperious main.

Your canvass hangs in ribbons, rent and torn;  
No gods are left to pray to in fresh need.  
A pine of Pontus born  
Of noble forest breed,

You boast your name and lineage—madly blind!  
Can painted timbers quell a seaman's fear?  
Beware! or else the wind  
Makes you its mock and jeer.

Your trouble late made sick this heart of mine,  
And still I love you, still am ill at ease.  
O, shun the sea, where shine  
The thick-sown Cyclades!

## XV. Pastor cum traheret per freta navibus

1.15

When the false swain was hurrying o'er the deep  
His Spartan hostess in the Idaean bark,  
Old Nereus laid the unwilling winds asleep,  
That all to Fate might hark,

Speaking through him:—"Home in ill hour you take  
A prize whom Greece shall claim with troops untold,  
Leagued by an oath your marriage tie to break  
And Priam's kingdom old.

Alas! what deaths you launch on Dardan realm!  
What toils are waiting, man and horse to tire!  
See! Pallas trims her aegis and her helm,  
Her chariot and her ire.

Vainly shall you, in Venus' favour strong,  
Your tresses comb, and for your dames divide  
On peaceful lyre the several parts of song;  
Vainly in chamber hide

From spears and Gnosian arrows, barb'd with fate,  
And battle's din, and Ajax in the chase  
Unconquer'd; those adulterous locks, though late,  
Shall gory dust deface.

Hark! 'tis the death-cry of your race! look back!  
Ulysses comes, and Pylian Nestor grey;  
See! Salaminian Teucer on your track,  
And Sthenelus, in the fray

Versed, or with whip and rein, should need require,  
No laggard. Merion too your eyes shall know  
From far. Tydides, fiercer than his sire,  
Pursues you, all aglow;

Him, as the stag forgets to graze for fright,  
Seeing the wolf at distance in the glade,  
And flies, high panting, you shall fly, despite  
Boasts to your leman made.

What though Achilles' wrathful fleet postpone  
The day of doom to Troy and Troy's proud dames,

Her towers shall fall, the number'd winters flown,  
Wrapp'd in Achaean flames."

XVI. O matre pulcra filia pulchrrior

1.16

O lovelier than the lovely dame  
That bore you, sentence as you please  
Those scurril verses, be it flame  
Your vengeance craves, or Hadrian seas.  
Not Cybele, nor he that haunts  
Rich Pytho, worse the brain confounds,  
Not Bacchus, nor the Corybants  
Clash their loud gongs with fiercer sounds  
Than savage wrath; nor sword nor spear  
Appals it, no, nor ocean's frown,  
Nor ravening fire, nor Jupiter  
In hideous ruin crashing down.  
Prometheus, forced, they say, to add  
To his prime clay some favourite part  
From every kind, took lion mad,  
And lodged its gall in man's poor heart.  
'Twas wrath that laid Thyestes low;  
'Tis wrath that oft destruction calls  
On cities, and invites the foe  
To drive his plough o'er ruin'd walls.  
Then calm your spirit; I can tell  
How once, when youth in all my veins  
Was glowing, blind with rage, I fell  
On friend and foe in ribald strains.  
Come, let me change my sour for sweet,  
And smile complacent as before:  
Hear me my palinode repeat,  
And give me back your heart once more.

## XVII. Velox amoenum saepe Lucretilem

1.17

The pleasures of Lucretilis  
Tempt Faunus from his Grecian seat;  
He keeps my little goats in bliss  
Apart from wind, and rain, and heat.  
In safety rambling o'er the sward  
For arbutus and for thyme they peer,  
The ladies of the unfragrant lord,  
Nor vipers, green with venom, fear,  
Nor savage wolves, of Mars' own breed,  
My Tyndaris, while Ustica's dell  
Is vocal with the silvan reed,  
And music thrills the limestone fell.  
Heaven is my guardian; heaven approves  
A blameless life, by song made sweet;  
Come hither, and the fields and groves  
Their horn shall empty at your feet.  
Here, shelter'd by a friendly tree,  
In Teian measures you shall sing  
Bright Circe and Penelope,  
Love-smitten both by one sharp sting.  
Here shall you quaff beneath the shade  
Sweet Lesbian draughts that injure none,  
Nor fear lest Mars the realm invade  
Of Semele's Thyonian son,  
Lest Cyrus on a foe too weak  
Lay the rude hand of wild excess,  
His passion on your chaplet wreck,  
Or spoil your undeserving dress.

## XVIII. Nullam, Vare, sacra vite prius severis arborem

1.18

Varus, are your trees in planting? put in none before the vine,  
In the rich domain of Tibur, by the walls of Catilus;  
There's a power above that hampers all that sober brains design,  
And the troubles man is heir to thus are quell'd, and only thus.  
Who can talk of want or warfare when the wine is in his head,  
Not of thee, good father Bacchus, and of Venus fair and bright?  
But should any dream of licence, there's a lesson may be read,  
How 'twas wine that drove the Centaurs with the Lapithae to fight.  
And the Thracians too may warn us; truth and falsehood, good and ill,  
How they mix them, when the wine-god's hand is heavy on them laid!  
Never, never, gracious Bacchus, may I move thee 'gainst thy will,  
Or uncover what is hidden in the verdure of thy shade!  
Silence thou thy savage cymbals, and the Berecynthine horn;  
In their train Self-love still follows, dully, desperately blind,  
And Vain-glory, towering upwards in its empty-headed scorn,  
And the Faith that keeps no secrets, with a window in its mind.

### XIX. Mater saeva Cupidinum

1.19

Cupid's mother, cruel dame,  
And Semele's Theban boy, and Licence bold,  
Bid me kindle into flame  
This heart, by waning passion now left cold.  
O, the charms of Glycera,  
That hue, more dazzling than the Parian stone!  
O, that sweet tormenting play,  
That too fair face, that blinds when look'd upon!  
Venus comes in all her might,  
Quits Cyprus for my heart, nor lets me tell  
Of the Parthian, bold in flight,  
Nor Scythian hordes, nor aught that breaks her spell.  
Heap the grassy altar up,  
Bring vervain, boys, and sacred frankincense;

Fill the sacrificial cup;  
A victim's blood will soothe her vehemence.

XX. Vile potabis modicis Sabinum

1.20

Not large my cups, nor rich my cheer,  
This Sabine wine, which erst I seal'd,  
That day the applauding theatre  
Your welcome peal'd,

Dear knight Maecenas! as 'twere fain  
That your paternal river's banks,  
And Vatican, in sportive strain,  
Should echo thanks.

For you Calenian grapes are press'd,  
And Caecuban; these cups of mine  
Falernum's bounty ne'er has bless'd,  
Nor Formian vine.

XXI. Dianam tenerae dicite virgines

1.21

Of Dian's praises, tender maidens, tell;  
Of Cynthus' unshorn god, young striplings, sing;  
And bright Latona, well  
Beloved of Heaven's high king.

Sing her that streams and silvan foliage loves,  
Whate'er on Algidus' chill brow is seen,  
In Erymanthian groves  
Dark-leaved, or Cragus green.

Sing Tempe too, glad youths, in strain as loud,

And Phoebus' birthplace, and that shoulder fair,  
His golden quiver proud  
And brother's lyre to bear.

His arm shall banish Hunger, Plague, and War  
To Persia and to Britain's coast, away  
From Rome and Caesar far,  
If you have zeal to pray.

## XXII. Integer vitae scelerisque purus

1.22

No need of Moorish archer's craft  
To guard the pure and stainless liver;  
He wants not, Fuscus, poison'd shaft  
To store his quiver,

Whether he traverse Libyan shoals,  
Or Caucasus, forlorn and horrent,  
Or lands where far Hydaspes rolls  
His fabled torrent.

A wolf, while roaming trouble-free  
In Sabine wood, as fancy led me,  
Unarm'd I sang my Lalage,  
Beheld, and fled me.

Dire monster! in her broad oak woods  
Fierce Daunia fosters none such other,  
Nor Juba's land, of lion broods  
The thirsty mother.

Place me where on the ice-bound plain  
No tree is cheer'd by summer breezes,

Where Jove descends in sleety rain  
Or sullen freezes;

Place me where none can live for heat,  
'Neath Phoebus' very chariot plant me,  
That smile so sweet, that voice so sweet,  
Shall still enchant me.

XXIII. Vitas hinnuleo me similis, Chloe

1.23

You fly me, Chloe, as o'er trackless hills  
A young fawn runs her timorous dam to find,  
Whom empty terror thrills  
Of woods and whispering wind.

Whether 'tis Spring's first shiver, faintly heard  
Through the light leaves, or lizards in the brake  
The rustling thorns have stirr'd,  
Her heart, her knees, they quake.

Yet I, who chase you, no grim lion am,  
No tiger fell, to crush you in my gripe:  
Come, learn to leave your dam,  
For lover's kisses ripe.

XXIV. Quis desiderio sit pudor aut modus

1.24

Why blush to let our tears unmeasured fall  
For one so dear? Begin the mournful stave,  
Melpomene, to whom the sire of all  
Sweet voice with music gave.

And sleeps he then the heavy sleep of death,

Quintilius? Piety, twin sister dear  
Of Justice! naked Truth! unsullied Faith!  
When will ye find his peer?

By many a good man wept, Quintilius dies;  
By none than you, my Virgil, trulier wept:  
Devout in vain, you chide the faithless skies,  
Asking your loan ill-kept.

No, though more suasive than the bard of Thrace  
You swept the lyre that trees were fain to hear,  
Ne'er should the blood revisit his pale face  
Whom once with wand severe

Mercury has folded with the sons of night,  
Untaught to prayer Fate's prison to unseal.  
Ah, heavy grief! but patience makes more light  
What sorrow may not heal.

#### XXVI. Musis amicus tristitiam et metus

1.26

The Muses love me: fear and grief,  
The winds may blow them to the sea;  
Who quail before the wintry chief  
Of Scythia's realm, is nought to me.  
What cloud o'er Tiridates lowers,  
I care not, I, O, nymph divine  
Of virgin springs, with sunniest flowers  
A chaplet for my Lamia twine,  
Pimplea sweet! my praise were vain  
Without thee. String this maiden lyre,  
Attune for him the Lesbian strain,  
O goddess, with thy sister quire!

## XXVII. Natis in usum laetitiae scyphis

1.27

What, fight with cups that should give joy?  
 'Tis barbarous; leave such savage ways  
 To Thracians. Bacchus, shamefaced boy,  
 Is blushing at your bloody frays.  
 The Median sabre! lights and wine!  
 Was stranger contrast ever seen?  
 Cease, cease this brawling, comrades mine,  
 And still upon your elbows lean.  
 Well, shall I take a toper's part  
 Of fierce Falernian? let our guest,  
 Megilla's brother, say what dart  
 Gave the death-wound that makes him blest.  
 He hesitates? no other hire  
 Shall tempt my sober brains. Whate'er  
 The goddess tames you, no base fire  
 She kindles; 'tis some gentle fair  
 Allures you still. Come, tell me truth,  
 And trust my honour—That the name?  
 That wild Charybdis yours? Poor youth!  
 O, you deserved a better flame!  
 What wizard, what Thessalian spell,  
 What god can save you, hamper'd thus?  
 To cope with this Chimaera fell  
 Would task another Pegasus.

## XXVIII. Te maris et terrae numeroque carentis harenae

1.28

The sea, the earth, the innumerable sand,  
 Archytas, thou couldst measure; now, alas!  
 A little dust on Matine shore has spann'd  
 That soaring spirit; vain it was to pass

The gates of heaven, and send thy soul in quest  
O'er air's wide realms; for thou hadst yet to die.  
Ay, dead is Pelops' father, heaven's own guest,  
And old Tithonus, rapt from earth to sky,  
And Minos, made the council-friend of Jove;  
And Panthus' son has yielded up his breath  
Once more, though down he pluck'd the shield, to prove  
His prowess under Troy, and bade grim death  
O'er skin and nerves alone exert its power,  
Not he, you grant, in nature meanly read.  
Yes, all "await the inevitable hour;"  
The downward journey all one day must tread.  
Some bleed, to glut the war-god's savage eyes;  
Fate meets the sailor from the hungry brine;  
Youth jostles age in funeral obsequies;  
Each brow in turn is touch'd by Proserpine.  
Me, too, Orion's mate, the Southern blast,  
Whelm'd in deep death beneath the Illyrian wave.  
But grudge not, sailor, of driven sand to cast  
A handful on my head, that owns no grave.  
So, though the eastern tempests loudly threat  
Hesperia's main, may green Venusia's crown  
Be stripp'd, while you lie warm; may blessings yet  
Stream from Tarentum's guard, great Neptune, down,  
And gracious Jove, into your open lap!  
What! shrink you not from crime whose punishment  
Falls on your innocent children? it may hap  
Imperious Fate will make yourself repent.  
My prayers shall reach the avengers of all wrong;  
No expiations shall the curse unbind.  
Great though your haste, I would not task you long;  
Thrice sprinkle dust, then scud before the wind.

## XXIX. Icci, beatis nunc Arabum invides

1.29

Your heart on Arab wealth is set,  
 Good Iccius: you would try your steel  
 On Saba's kings, unconquer'd yet,  
 And make the Mede your fetters feel.  
 Come, tell me what barbarian fair  
 Will serve you now, her bridegroom slain?  
 What page from court with essenced hair  
 Will tender you the bowl you drain,  
 Well skill'd to bend the Serian bow  
 His father carried? Who shall say  
 That rivers may not uphill flow,  
 And Tiber's self return one day,  
 If you would change Panaetius' works,  
 That costly purchase, and the clan  
 Of Socrates, for shields and dirks,  
 Whom once we thought a saner man?

## XXX. O Venus regina Cnidi Paphique

1.30

Come, Cnidian, Paphian Venus, come,  
 Thy well-beloved Cyprus spurn,  
 Haste, where for thee in Glycera's home  
 Sweet odours burn.

Bring too thy Cupid, glowing warm,  
 Graces and Nymphs, unzoned and free,  
 And Youth, that lacking thee lacks charm,  
 And Mercury.

## XXXI. Quid dedicatum poscit Apollinem

1.31

What blessing shall the bard entreat  
 The god he hallows, as he pours  
 The winecup? Not the mounds of wheat  
 That load Sardinian threshing floors;  
 Not Indian gold or ivory—no,  
 Nor flocks that o'er Calabria stray,  
 Nor fields that Liris, still and slow,  
 Is eating, unperceived, away.  
 Let those whose fate allows them train  
 Calenum's vine; let trader bold  
 From golden cups rich liquor drain  
 For wares of Syria bought and sold,  
 Heaven's favourite, sooth, for thrice a year  
 He comes and goes across the brine  
 Undamaged. I in plenty here  
 On endives, mallows, succory dine.  
 O grant me, Phoebus, calm content,  
 Strength unimpair'd, a mind entire,  
 Old age without dishonour spent,  
 Nor unbefriended by the lyre!

### XXXII. Poscimur. si quid vacui sub umbra

1.32

They call;—if aught in shady dell  
 We twain have warbled, to remain  
 Long months or years, now breathe, my shell,  
 A Roman strain,

Thou, strung by Lesbos' minstrel hand,  
 The bard, who 'mid the clash of steel,  
 Or haply mooring to the strand  
 His batter'd keel,

Of Bacchus and the Muses sung,  
And Cupid, still at Venus' side,  
And Lycus, beautiful and young,  
Dark-hair'd, dark-eyed.

O sweetest lyre, to Phoebus dear,  
Delight of Jove's high festival,  
Blest balm in trouble, hail and hear  
Whene'er I call!

XXXIII. Albi, ne doleas plus nimio memor

1.33

What, Albius! why this passionate despair  
For cruel Glycera? why melt your voice  
In dolorous strains, because the perjured fair  
Has made a younger choice?

See, narrow-brow'd Lycoris, how she glows  
For Cyrus! Cyrus turns away his head  
To Pholoe's frown; but sooner gentle roes  
Apulian wolves shall wed,

Than Pholoe to so mean a conqueror strike:  
So Venus wills it; 'neath her brazen yoke  
She loves to couple forms and minds unlike,  
All for a heartless joke.

For me sweet Love had forged a milder spell;  
But Myrtale still kept me her fond slave,  
More stormy she than the tempestuous swell  
That crests Calabria's wave.

## XXXIV. Parcus deorum cultor et infrequens

1.34

My prayers were scant, my offerings few,  
While witless wisdom fool'd my mind;  
But now I trim my sails anew,  
And trace the course I left behind.  
For lo! the sire of heaven on high,  
By whose fierce bolts the clouds are riven,  
To-day through an unclouded sky  
His thundering steeds and car has driven.  
E'en now dull earth and wandering floods,  
And Atlas' limitary range,  
And Styx, and Taenarus' dark abodes  
Are reeling. He can lowliest change  
And loftiest; bring the mighty down  
And lift the weak; with whirring flight  
Comes Fortune, plucks the monarch's crown,  
And decks therewith some meaner wight.

## XXXV. O diva, gratum quae regis Antium

1.35

Lady of Antium, grave and stern!  
O Goddess, who canst lift the low  
To high estate, and sudden turn  
A triumph to a funeral show!  
Thee the poor hind that tills the soil  
Implores; their queen they own in thee,  
Who in Bithynian vessel toil  
Amid the vex'd Carpathian sea.  
Thee Dacians fierce, and Scythian hordes,  
Peoples and towns, and Rome, their head,  
And mothers of barbarian lords,  
And tyrants in their purple dread,

Lest, spurn'd by thee in scorn, should fall  
 The state's tall prop, lest crowds on fire  
 To arms, to arms! the loiterers call,  
 And thrones be tumbled in the mire.  
 Necessity precedes thee still  
 With hard fierce eyes and heavy tramp:  
 Her hand the nails and wedges fill,  
 The molten lead and stubborn clamp.  
 Hope, precious Truth in garb of white,  
 Attend thee still, nor quit thy side  
 When with changed robes thou tak'st thy flight  
 In anger from the homes of pride.  
 Then the false herd, the faithless fair,  
 Start backward; when the wine runs dry,  
 The jocund guests, too light to bear  
 An equal yoke, asunder fly.  
 O shield our Caesar as he goes  
 To furthest Britain, and his band,  
 Rome's harvest! Send on Eastern foes  
 Their fear, and on the Red Sea strand!  
 O wounds that scarce have ceased to run!  
 O brother's blood! O iron time!  
 What horror have we left undone?  
 Has conscience shrunk from aught of crime?  
 What shrine has rapine held in awe?  
 What altar spared? O haste and beat  
 The blunted steel we yet may draw  
 On Arab and on Massagete!

### XXXVI. Et ture et fidibus iuvat

1.36

Bid the lyre and cittern play;  
 Enkindle incense, shed the victim's gore;

Heaven has watch'd o'er Numida,  
 And brings him safe from far Hispania's shore.  
 Now, returning, he bestows  
 On each dear comrade all the love he can;  
 But to Lamia most he owes,  
 By whose sweet side he grew from boy to man.  
 Note we in our calendar  
 This festal day with whitest mark from Crete:  
 Let it flow, the old wine-jar,  
 And ply to Salian time your restless feet.  
 Damalis tosses off her wine,  
 But Bassus sure must prove her match to-night.  
 Give us roses all to twine,  
 And parsley green, and lilies deathly white.  
 Every melting eye will rest  
 On Damalis' lovely face; but none may part  
 Damalis from our new-found guest;  
 She clings, and clings, like ivy, round his heart.

### XXXVII. Nunc est bibendum, nunc pede libero

1.37

Now drink we deep, now featly tread  
 A measure; now before each shrine  
 With Salian feasts the table spread;  
 The time invites us, comrades mine.  
 'Twas shame to broach, before to-day,  
 The Caecuban, while Egypt's dame  
 Threaten'd our power in dust to lay  
 And wrap the Capitol in flame,  
 Girt with her foul emasculate throng,  
 By Fortune's sweet new wine befool'd,  
 In hope's ungovern'd weakness strong  
 To hope for all; but soon she cool'd,

To see one ship from burning 'scape;  
 Great Caesar taught her dizzy brain,  
 Made mad by Mareotic grape,  
 To feel the sobering truth of pain,  
 And gave her chase from Italy,  
 As after doves fierce falcons speed,  
 As hunters 'neath Haemonia's sky  
 Chase the tired hare, so might he lead  
 The fiend enchain'd; *she* sought to die  
 More nobly, nor with woman's dread  
 Quail'd at the steel, nor timorously  
 In her fleet ships to covert fled.  
 Amid her ruin'd halls she stood  
 Unblench'd, and fearless to the end  
 Grasp'd the fell snakes, that all her blood  
 Might with the cold black venom blend,  
 Death's purpose flushing in her face;  
 Nor to our ships the glory gave,  
 That she, no vulgar dame, should grace  
 A triumph, crownless, and a slave.

### XXXVIII. Persicos odi, puer, adparatus

1.38

No Persian cumber, boy, for me;  
 I hate your garlands linden-plaited;  
 Leave winter's rose where on the tree  
 It hangs belated.

Wreath me plain myrtle; never think  
 Plain myrtle either's wear unfitting,  
 Yours as you wait, mine as I drink  
 In vine-bower sitting.

## Book II

## I. Motum ex Metello consule civicum

2.1

The broils that from Metellus date,  
The secret springs, the dark intrigues,  
The freaks of Fortune, and the great  
Confederate in disastrous leagues,  
And arms with uncleansed slaughter red,  
A work of danger and distrust,  
You treat, as one on fire should tread,  
Scarce hid by treacherous ashen crust.  
Let Tragedy's stern muse be mute  
Awhile; and when your order'd page  
Has told Rome's tale, that buskin'd foot  
Again shall mount the Attic stage,  
Pollio, the pale defendant's shield,  
In deep debate the senate's stay,  
The hero of Dalmatic field  
By Triumph crown'd with deathless bay.  
E'en now with trumpet's threatening blare  
You thrill our ears; the clarion brays;  
The lightnings of the armour scare  
The steed, and daunt the rider's gaze.  
Methinks I hear of leaders proud  
With no uncomely dust distain'd,  
And all the world by conquest bow'd,  
And only Cato's soul unchain'd.  
Yes, Juno and the powers on high  
That left their Afric to its doom,  
Have led the victors' progeny  
As victims to Jugurtha's tomb.  
What field, by Latian blood-drops fed,

Proclaims not the unnatural deeds  
It buries, and the earthquake dread  
Whose distant thunder shook the Medes?  
What gulf, what river has not seen  
Those sights of sorrow? nay, what sea  
Has Daunian carnage yet left green?  
What coast from Roman blood is free?  
But pause, gay Muse, nor leave your play  
Another Cean dirge to sing;  
With me to Venus' bower away,  
And there attune a lighter string.

## II. Nullus argento color est avaris

2.2

The silver, Sallust, shows not fair  
While buried in the greedy mine:  
You love it not till moderate wear  
Have given it shine.

Honour to Proculeius! he  
To brethren play'd a father's part;  
Fame shall embalm through years to be  
That noble heart.

Who curbs a greedy soul may boast  
More power than if his broad-based throne  
Bridged Libya's sea, and either coast  
Were all his own.

Indulgence bids the dropsy grow;  
Who fain would quench the palate's flame  
Must rescue from the watery foe  
The pale weak frame.

Phraates, throned where Cyrus sate,  
May count for blest with vulgar herds,  
But not with Virtue; soon or late  
From lying words

She weans men's lips; for him she keeps  
The crown, the purple, and the bays,  
Who dares to look on treasure-heaps  
With unblench'd gaze.

### III. Aequam memento rebus in arduis

2.3

An equal mind, when storms o'ercloud,  
Maintain, nor 'neath a brighter sky  
Let pleasure make your heart too proud,  
O Dellius, Dellius! sure to die,  
Whether in gloom you spend each year,  
Or through long holydays at ease  
In grassy nook your spirit cheer  
With old Falernian vintages,  
Where poplar pale, and pine-tree high  
Their hospitable shadows spread  
Entwined, and panting waters try  
To hurry down their zigzag bed.  
Bring wine and scents, and roses' bloom,  
Too brief, alas! to that sweet place,  
While life, and fortune, and the loom  
Of the Three Sisters yield you grace.  
Soon must you leave the woods you buy,  
Your villa, wash'd by Tiber's flow,  
Leave,—and your treasures, heap'd so high,  
Your reckless heir will level low.

Whether from Argos' founder born  
In wealth you lived beneath the sun,  
Or nursed in beggary and scorn,  
You fall to Death, who pities none.  
One way all travel; the dark urn  
Shakes each man's lot, that soon or late  
Will force him, hopeless of return,  
On board the exile-ship of Fate.

#### IV. Ne sit ancillae tibi amor pudori

2.4

Why, Xanthias, blush to own you love  
Your slave? Briseis, long ago,  
A captive, could Achilles move  
With breast of snow.

Tecmessa's charms enslaved her lord,  
Stout Ajax, heir of Telamon;  
Atrides, in his pride, adored  
The maid he won,

When Troy to Thessaly gave way,  
And Hector's all too quick decease  
Made Pergamus an easier prey  
To wearied Greece.

What if, as auburn Phyllis' mate,  
You graft yourself on regal stem?  
Oh yes! be sure her sires were great;  
She weeps for *them*.

Believe me, from no rascal scum  
Your charmer sprang; so true a flame,

Such hate of greed, could never come  
From vulgar dame.

With honest fervour I commend  
Those lips, those eyes; you need not fear  
A rival, hurrying on to end  
His fortieth year.

## VI. Septimi, Gadis aditure mecum et

2.6

Septimius, who with me would brave  
Far Gades, and Cantabrian land  
Untamed by Rome, and Moorish wave  
That whirls the sand;

Fair Tibur, town of Argive kings,  
There would I end my days serene,  
At rest from seas and travellings,  
And service seen.

Should angry Fate those wishes foil,  
Then let me seek Galesus, sweet  
To skin-clad sheep, and that rich soil,  
The Spartan's seat.

O, what can match the green recess,  
Whose honey not to Hybla yields,  
Whose olives vie with those that bless  
Venafrum's fields?

Long springs, mild winters glad that spot  
By Jove's good grace, and Aulon, dear  
To fruitful Bacchus, envies not

Falernian cheer.

That spot, those happy heights desire  
Our sojourn; there, when life shall end,  
Your tear shall dew my yet warm pyre,  
Your bard and friend.

VII. O saepe mecum tempus in ultimum

2.7

O, oft with me in troublous time  
Involved, when Brutus warr'd in Greece,  
Who gives you back to your own clime  
And your own gods, a man of peace,  
Pompey, the earliest friend I knew,  
With whom I oft cut short the hours  
With wine, my hair bright bathed in dew  
Of Syrian oils, and wreathed with flowers?  
With you I shared Philippi's rout,  
Unseemly parted from my shield,  
When Valour fell, and warriors stout  
Were tumbled on the inglorious field:  
But I was saved by Mercury,  
Wrapp'd in thick mist, yet trembling sore,  
While you to that tempestuous sea  
Were swept by battle's tide once more.  
Come, pay to Jove the feast you owe;  
Lay down those limbs, with warfare spent,  
Beneath my laurel; nor be slow  
To drain my cask; for you 'twas meant.  
Lethe's true draught is Massic wine;  
Fill high the goblet; pour out free  
Rich streams of unguent. Who will twine  
The hasty wreath from myrtle-tree

Or parsley? Whom will Venus seat  
Chairman of cups? Are Bacchants sane?  
Then I'll be sober. O, 'tis sweet  
To fool, when friends come home again!

VIII. Vlla si iuris tibi peierati

2.8

Had chastisement for perjured truth,  
Barine, mark'd you with a curse—  
Did one wry nail, or one black tooth,  
But make you worse—

I'd trust you; but, when plighted lies  
Have pledged you deepest, lovelier far  
You sparkle forth, of all young eyes  
The ruling star.

'Tis gain to mock your mother's bones,  
And night's still signs, and all the sky,  
And gods, that on their glorious thrones  
Chill Death defy.

Ay, Venus smiles; the pure nymphs smile,  
And Cupid, tyrant-lord of hearts,  
Sharpening on bloody stone the while  
His fiery darts.

New captives fill the nets you weave;  
New slaves are bred; and those before,  
Though oft they threaten, never leave  
Your godless door.

The mother dreads you for her son,

The thrifty sire, the new-wed bride,  
Lest, lured by you, her precious one  
Should leave her side.

IX. Non semper imbres nubibus hispidos

2.9

The rain, it rains not every day  
On the soak'd meads; the Caspian main  
Not always feels the unequal sway  
Of storms, nor on Armenia's plain,  
Dear Valgius, lies the cold dull snow  
Through all the year; nor northwinds keen  
Upon Garganian oakwoods blow,  
And strip the ashes of their green.  
You still with tearful tones pursue  
Your lost, lost Mystes; Hesper sees  
Your passion when he brings the dew,  
And when before the sun he flees.  
Yet not for loved Antilochus  
Grey Nestor wasted all his years  
In grief; nor o'er young Troilus  
His parents' and his sisters' tears  
For ever flow'd. At length have done  
With these soft sorrows; rather tell  
Of Caesar's trophies newly won,  
And hoar Niphates' icy fell,  
And Medus' flood, 'mid conquer'd tribes  
Rolling a less presumptuous tide,  
And Scythians taught, as Rome prescribes,  
Henceforth o'er narrower steppes to ride.

X. Rectius vives, Licini, neque altum

2.10

Licinius, trust a seaman's lore:  
Steer not too boldly to the deep,  
Nor, fearing storms, by treacherous shore  
Too closely creep.

Who makes the golden mean his guide,  
Shuns miser's cabin, foul and dark,  
Shuns gilded roofs, where pomp and pride  
Are envy's mark.

With fiercer blasts the pine's dim height  
Is rock'd; proud towers with heavier fall  
Crash to the ground; and thunders smite  
The mountains tall.

In sadness hope, in gladness fear  
'Gainst coming change will fortify  
Your breast. The storms that Jupiter  
Sweeps o'er the sky

He chases. Why should rain to-day  
Bring rain to-morrow? Python's foe  
Is pleased sometimes his lyre to play,  
Nor bends his bow.

Be brave in trouble; meet distress  
With dauntless front; but when the gale  
Too prosperous blows, be wise no less,  
And shorten sail.

## XI. Quid bellicosus Cantaber et Scythes

O ask not what those sons of war,  
 Cantabrian, Scythian, each intend,  
 Disjoin'd from us by Hadria's bar,  
 Nor puzzle, Quintius, how to spend  
 A life so simple. Youth removes,  
 And Beauty too; and hoar Decay  
 Drives out the wanton tribe of Loves  
 And Sleep, that came or night or day.  
 The sweet spring-flowers not always keep  
 Their bloom, nor moonlight shines the same  
 Each evening. Why with thoughts too deep  
 O'ertask a mind of mortal frame?  
 Why not, just thrown at careless ease  
 'Neath plane or pine, our locks of grey  
 Perfumed with Syrian essences  
 And wreathed with roses, while we may,  
 Lie drinking? Bacchus puts to shame  
 The cares that waste us. Where's the slave  
 To quench the fierce Falernian's flame  
 With water from the passing wave?  
 Who'll coax coy Lyde from her home?  
 Go, bid her take her ivory lyre,  
 The runaway, and haste to come,  
 Her wild hair bound with Spartan tire.

## XII. Nolis longa ferae bella Numantiae

2.12

The weary war where fierce Numantia bled,  
 Fell Hannibal, the swoln Sicilian main  
 Purpled with Punic blood—not mine to wed  
 These to the lyre's soft strain,

Nor cruel Lapithae, nor, mad with wine,

Centaurs, nor, by Herculean arm o'ercome,  
The earth-born youth, whose terrors dimm'd the shine  
Of the resplendent dome

Of ancient Saturn. You, Maecenas, best  
In pictured prose of Caesar's warrior feats  
Will tell, and captive kings with haughty crest  
Led through the Roman streets.

On me the Muse has laid her charge to tell  
Of your Licymnia's voice, the lustrous hue  
Of her bright eye, her heart that beats so well  
To mutual passion true:

How nought she does but lends her added grace,  
Whether she dance, or join in bantering play,  
Or with soft arms the maiden choir embrace  
On great Diana's day.

Say, would you change for all the wealth possess  
By rich Achaemenes or Phrygia's heir,  
Or the full stores of Araby the blest,  
One lock of her dear hair,

While to your burning lips she bends her neck,  
Or with kind cruelty denies the due  
She means you not to beg for, but to take,  
Or snatches it from you?

### XIII. Ille et nefasto te posuit die

2.13

Black day he chose for planting thee,  
Accurst he rear'd thee from the ground,

The bane of children yet to be,  
The scandal of the village round.  
His father's throat the monster press'd  
Beside, and on his hearthstone spilt,  
I ween, the blood of midnight guest;  
Black Colchian drugs, whate'er of guilt  
Is hatch'd on earth, he dealt in all—  
Who planted in my rural stead  
Thee, fatal wood, thee, sure to fall  
Upon thy blameless master's head.  
The dangers of the hour! no thought  
We give them; Punic seaman's fear  
Is all of Bosphorus, nor aught  
Recks he of pitfalls elsewhere;  
The soldier fears the mask'd retreat  
Of Parthia; Parthia dreads the thrall  
Of Rome; but Death with noiseless feet  
Has stolen and will steal on all.  
How near dark Pluto's court I stood,  
And Aeacus' judicial throne,  
The blest seclusion of the good,  
And Sappho, with sweet lyric moan  
Bewailing her ungentle sex,  
And thee, Alcaeus, louder far  
Chanting thy tale of woful wrecks,  
Of woful exile, woful war!  
In sacred awe the silent dead  
Attend on each: but when the song  
Of combat tells and tyrants fled,  
Keen ears, press'd shoulders, closer throng.  
What marvel, when at those sweet airs  
The hundred-headed beast spell-bound  
Each black ear droops, and Furies' hairs

Uncoil their serpents at the sound?  
Prometheus too and Pelops' sire  
In listening lose the sense of woe;  
Orion hearkens to the lyre,  
And lets the lynx and lion go.

#### XIV. Eheu fugaces, Postume, Postume

2.14

Ah, Postumus! they fleet away,  
Our years, nor piety one hour  
Can win from wrinkles and decay,  
And Death's indomitable power;  
Not though three hundred bullocks flame  
Each year, to soothe the tearless king  
Who holds huge Geryon's triple frame  
And Tityos in his watery ring,  
That circling flood, which all must stem,  
Who eat the fruits that Nature yields,  
Wearers of haughtiest diadem,  
Or humblest tillers of the fields.  
In vain we shun war's contact red  
Or storm-tost spray of Hadrian main:  
In vain, the season through, we dread  
For our frail lives Scirocco's bane.  
Cocytus' black and stagnant ooze  
Must welcome you, and Danaus' seed  
Ill-famed, and ancient Sisyphus  
To never-ending toil decreed.  
Your land, your house, your lovely bride  
Must lose you; of your cherish'd trees  
None to its fleeting master's side  
Will cleave, but those sad cypresses.  
Your heir, a larger soul, will drain

The hundred-padlock'd Caecuban,  
 And richer spilth the pavement stain  
 Than e'er at pontiff's supper ran.

XV. Iam pauca aratro iugera regiae

2.15

Few roods of ground the piles we raise  
 Will leave to plough; ponds wider spread  
 Than Lucrine lake will meet the gaze  
 On every side; the plane unwed  
 Will top the elm; the violet-bed,  
 The myrtle, each delicious sweet,  
 On olive-grounds their scent will shed,  
 Where once were fruit-trees yielding meat;  
 Thick bays will screen the midday range  
 Of fiercest suns. Not such the rule  
 Of Romulus, and Cato sage,  
 And all the bearded, good old school.  
 Each Roman's wealth was little worth,  
 His country's much; no colonnade  
 For private pleasance wooed the North  
 With cool "proximity of shade."  
 None might the casual sod disdain  
 To roof his home; a town alone,  
 At public charge, a sacred fane  
 Were honour'd with the pomp of stone.

XVI. Otium divos rogat in patenti

2.16

For ease, in wide Aegean caught,  
 The sailor prays, when clouds are hiding  
 The moon, nor shines of starlight aught  
 For seaman's guiding:

For ease the Mede, with quiver gay:  
For ease rude Thrace, in battle cruel:  
Can purple buy it, Grosphus? Nay,  
Nor gold, nor jewel.

No pomp, no lictor clears the way  
'Mid rabble-routs of troublous feelings,  
Nor quells the cares that sport and play  
Round gilded ceilings.

More happy he whose modest board  
His father's well-worn silver brightens;  
No fear, nor lust for sordid hoard,  
His light sleep frightens.

Why bend our bows of little span?  
Why change our homes for regions under  
Another sun? What exiled man  
From self can sunder?

Care climbs the bark, and trims the sail,  
Curst fiend! nor troops of horse can 'scape her,  
More swift than stag, more swift than gale  
That drives the vapour.

Blest in the present, look not forth  
On ills beyond, but soothe each bitter  
With slow, calm smile. No suns on earth  
Unclouded glitter.

Achilles' light was quench'd at noon;  
A long decay Tithonus minish'd;

My hours, it may be, yet will run  
When yours are finish'd.

For you Sicilian heifers low,  
Bleat countless flocks; for you are neighing  
Proud coursers; Afric purples glow  
For your arraying

With double dyes; a small domain,  
The soul that breathed in Grecian harping,  
My portion these; and high disdain  
Of ribald carping.

XVII. Cur me querelis exanimas tuis

2.17

Why rend my heart with that sad sigh?  
It cannot please the gods or me  
That you, Maecenas, first should die,  
My pillar of prosperity.  
Ah! should I lose one half my soul  
Untimely, can the other stay  
Behind it? Life that is not whole,  
Is *that* as sweet? The self-same day  
Shall crush us twain; no idle oath  
Has Horace sworn; whene'er you go,  
We both will travel, travel both  
The last dark journey down below.  
No, not Chimaera's fiery breath,  
Nor Gyas, could he rise again,  
Shall part us; Justice, strong as death,  
So wills it; so the Fates ordain.  
Whether 'twas Libra saw me born  
Or angry Scorpio, lord malign

Of natal hour, or Capricorn,  
The tyrant of the western brine,  
Our planets sure with concord strange  
Are blended. You by Jove's blest power  
Were snatch'd from out the baleful range  
Of Saturn, and the evil hour  
Was stay'd, when rapturous benches full  
Three times the auspicious thunder peal'd;  
Me the curst trunk, that smote my skull,  
Had slain; but Faunus, strong to shield  
The friends of Mercury, check'd the blow  
In mid descent. Be sure to pay  
The victims and the fane you owe;  
Your bard a humbler lamb will slay.

#### XVIII. Non ebur neque aureum

2.18

Carven ivory have I none;  
No golden cornice in my dwelling shines;  
Pillars choice of Libyan stone  
Upbear no architrave from Attic mines;  
'Twas not mine to enter in  
To Attalus' broad realms, an unknown heir,  
Nor for me fair clients spin  
Laconian purples for their patron's wear.  
Truth is mine, and Genius mine;  
The rich man comes, and knocks at my low door:  
Favour'd thus, I ne'er repine,  
Nor weary out indulgent Heaven for more:  
In my Sabine homestead blest,  
Why should I further tax a generous friend?  
Suns are hurrying suns a-west,  
And newborn moons make speed to meet their end.

You have hands to square and hew  
 Vast marble-blocks, hard on your day of doom,  
 Ever building mansions new,  
 Nor thinking of the mansion of the tomb.  
 Now you press on ocean's bound,  
 Where waves on Baiae beat, as earth were scant;  
 Now absorb your neighbour's ground,  
 And tear his landmarks up, your own to plant.  
 Hedges set round clients' farms  
 Your avarice tramples; see, the outcasts fly,  
 Wife and husband, in their arms  
 Their fathers' gods, their squalid family.  
 Yet no hall that wealth e'er plann'd  
 Waits you more surely than the wider room  
 Traced by Death's yet greedier hand.  
 Why strain so far? you cannot leap the tomb.  
 Earth removes the impartial sod  
 Alike for beggar and for monarch's child:  
 Nor the slave of Hell's dark god  
 Convey'd Prometheus back, with bribe beguiled.  
 Pelops he and Pelops' sire  
 Holds, spite of pride, in close captivity;  
 Beggars, who of labour tire,  
 Call'd or uncall'd, he hears and sets them free.

### XIX. Bacchum in remotis carmina rupibus

2.19

Bacchus I saw in mountain glades  
 Retired (believe it, after years!)  
 Teaching his strains to Dryad maids,  
 While goat-hoof'd satyrs prick'd their ears.  
 Evoe! my eyes with terror glare;  
 My heart is revelling with the god;

'Tis madness! Evoe! spare, O spare,  
 Dread wielder of the ivied rod!  
 Yes, I may sing the Thyiad crew,  
 The stream of wine, the sparkling rills  
 That run with milk, and honey-dew  
 That from the hollow trunk distils;  
 And I may sing thy consort's crown,  
 New set in heaven, and Pentheus' hall  
 With ruthless ruin thundering down,  
 And proud Lycurgus' funeral.  
 Thou turn'st the rivers, thou the sea;  
 Thou, on far summits, moist with wine,  
 Thy Bacchants' tresses harmlessly  
 Dost knot with living serpent-twine.  
 Thou, when the giants, threatening wrack,  
 Were clambering up Jove's citadel,  
 Didst hurl o'erweening Rhoetus back,  
 In tooth and claw a lion fell.  
 Who knew thy feats in dance and play  
 Deem'd thee belike for war's rough game  
 Unmeet: but peace and battle-fray  
 Found thee, their centre, still the same.  
 Grim Cerberus wagg'd his tail to see  
 Thy golden horn, nor dream'd of wrong,  
 But gently fawning, follow'd thee,  
 And lick'd thy feet with triple tongue.

XX. Non usitata nec tenui ferar

2.20

No vulgar wing, nor weakly plied,  
 Shall bear me through the liquid sky;  
 A two-form'd bard, no more to bide  
 Within the range of envy's eye

'Mid haunts of men. I, all ungraced  
By gentle blood, I, whom you call  
Your friend, Maecenas, shall not taste  
Of death, nor chafe in Lethe's thrall.  
E'en now a rougher skin expands  
Along my legs: above I change  
To a white bird; and o'er my hands  
And shoulders grows a plumage strange:  
Fleeter than Icarus, see me float  
O'er Bosphorus, singing as I go,  
And o'er Gaetulian sands remote,  
And Hyperborean fields of snow;  
By Dacian horde, that masks its fear  
Of Marsic steel, shall I be known,  
And furthest Scythian: Spain shall hear  
My warbling, and the banks of Rhone.  
No dirges for my fancied death;  
No weak lament, no mournful stave;  
All clamorous grief were waste of breath,  
And vain the tribute of a grave.

### Book III

#### I. Odi profanum volgus et arceo

3.1

I bid the unhallow'd crowd avaunt!  
Keep holy silence; strains unknown  
Till now, the Muses' hierophant,  
I sing to youths and maids alone.  
Kings o'er their flocks the sceptre wield;  
E'en kings beneath Jove's sceptre bow:  
Victor in giant battle-field,  
He moves all nature with his brow.

This man his planted walks extends  
Beyond his peers; an older name  
One to the people's choice commends;  
One boasts a more unsullied fame;  
One plumes him on a larger crowd  
Of clients. What are great or small?  
Death takes the mean man with the proud;  
The fatal urn has room for all.  
When guilty Pomp the drawn sword sees  
Hung o'er her, richest feasts in vain  
Strain their sweet juice her taste to please;  
No lutes, no singing birds again  
Will bring her sleep. Sleep knows no pride;  
It scorns not cots of village hinds,  
Nor shadow-trembling river-side,  
Nor Tempe, stirr'd by western winds.  
Who, having competence, has all,  
The tumult of the sea defies,  
Nor fears Arcturus' angry fall,  
Nor fears the Kid-star's sullen rise,  
Though hail-storms on the vineyard beat,  
Though crops deceive, though trees complain,  
One while of showers, one while of heat,  
One while of winter's barbarous reign.  
Fish feel the narrowing of the main  
From sunken piles, while on the strand  
Contractors with their busy train  
Let down huge stones, and lords of land  
Affect the sea: but fierce Alarm  
Can clamber to the master's side:  
Black Cares can up the galley swarm,  
And close behind the horseman ride.  
If Phrygian marbles soothe not pain,

Nor star-bright purple's costliest wear,  
 Nor vines of true Falernian strain,  
 Nor Achaemenian spices rare,  
 Why with rich gate and pillar'd range  
 Upbuild new mansions, twice as high,  
 Or why my Sabine vale exchange  
 For more laborious luxury?

## II. Angustam amice pauperiem pati

### 3.2

To suffer hardness with good cheer,  
 In sternest school of warfare bred,  
 Our youth should learn; let steed and spear  
 Make him one day the Parthian's dread;  
 Cold skies, keen perils, brace his life.  
 Methinks I see from rampired town  
 Some battling tyrant's matron wife,  
 Some maiden, look in terror down,—  
 “Ah, my dear lord, untrain'd in war!  
 O tempt not the infuriate mood  
 Of that fell lion! see! from far  
 He plunges through a tide of blood!”  
 What joy, for fatherland to die!  
 Death's darts e'en flying feet o'ertake,  
 Nor spare a recreant chivalry,  
 A back that cowers, or loins that quake.  
 True Virtue never knows defeat:  
*Her* robes she keeps unsullied still,  
 Nor takes, nor quits, *her* curule seat  
 To please a people's veering will.  
 True Virtue opens heaven to worth:  
 She makes the way she does not find:  
 The vulgar crowd, the humid earth,

Her soaring pinion leaves behind.  
 Seal'd lips have blessings sure to come:  
 Who drags Eleusis' rite to-day,  
 That man shall never share my home,  
 Or join my voyage: roofs give way  
 And boats are wreck'd: true men and thieves  
 Neglected Justice oft confounds:  
 Though Vengeance halt, she seldom leaves  
 The wretch whose flying steps she hounds.

### III. Iustum et tenacem propositi virum

3.3

The man of firm and righteous will,  
 No rabble, clamorous for the wrong,  
 No tyrant's brow, whose frown may kill,  
 Can shake the strength that makes him strong:  
 Not winds, that chafe the sea they sway,  
 Nor Jove's right hand, with lightning red:  
 Should Nature's pillar'd frame give way,  
 That wreck would strike one fearless head.  
 Pollux and roving Hercules  
 Thus won their way to Heaven's proud steep,  
 'Mid whom Augustus, couch'd at ease,  
 Dyes his red lips with nectar deep.  
 For this, great Bacchus, tigers drew  
 Thy glorious car, untaught to slave  
 In harness: thus Quirinus flew  
 On Mars' wing'd steeds from Acheron's wave,  
 When Juno spoke with Heaven's assent:  
 "O Ilium, Ilium, wretched town!  
 The judge accurst, incontinent,  
 And stranger dame have dragg'd thee down.  
 Pallas and I, since Priam's sire

Denied the gods his pledged reward,  
Had doom'd them all to sword and fire,  
The people and their perjured lord.  
No more the adulterous guest can charm  
The Spartan queen: the house forsworn  
No more repels by Hector's arm  
My warriors, baffled and outworn:  
Hush'd is the war our strife made long:  
I welcome now, my hatred o'er,  
A grandson in the child of wrong,  
Him whom the Trojan priestess bore.  
Receive him, Mars! the gates of flame  
May open: let him taste forgiven  
The nectar, and enrol his name  
Among the peaceful ranks of Heaven.  
Let the wide waters sever still  
Ilium and Rome, the exiled race  
May reign and prosper where they will:  
So but in Paris' burial-place  
The cattle sport, the wild beasts hide  
Their cubs, the Capitol may stand  
All bright, and Rome in warlike pride  
O'er Media stretch a conqueror's hand.  
Aye, let her scatter far and wide  
Her terror, where the land-lock'd waves  
Europe from Afric's shore divide,  
Where swelling Nile the corn-field laves—  
Of strength more potent to disdain  
Hid gold, best buried in the mine,  
Than gather it with hand profane,  
That for man's greed would rob a shrine.  
Whate'er the bound to earth ordain'd,  
There let her reach the arm of power,

Travelling, where raves the fire unrein'd,  
 And where the storm-cloud and the shower.  
 Yet, warlike Roman, know thy doom,  
 Nor, drunken with a conqueror's joy,  
 Or blind with duteous zeal, presume  
 To build again ancestral Troy.  
 Should Troy revive to hateful life,  
 Her star again should set in gore,  
 While I, Jove's sister and his wife,  
 To victory led my host once more.  
 Though Phoebus thrice in brazen mail  
 Should case her towers, they thrice should fall,  
 Storm'd by my Greeks: thrice wives should wail  
 Husband and son, themselves in thrall."—  
 Such thunders from the lyre of love!  
 Back, wayward Muse! refrain, refrain  
 To tell the talk of gods above,  
 And dwarf high themes in puny strain.

#### IV. Descende caelo et dic age tibia

3.4

Come down, Calliope, from above:  
 Breathe on the pipe a strain of fire:  
 Or if a graver note thou love,  
 With Phoebus' cittern and his lyre.  
 You hear her? or is this the play  
 Of fond illusion? Hark! meseems  
 Through gardens of the good I stray,  
 'Mid murmuring gales and purling streams.  
 Me, as I lay on Vultur's steep,  
 A truant past Apulia's bound,  
 O'ertired, poor child, with play and sleep,  
 With living green the stock-doves crown'd—

A legend, nay, a miracle,  
By Acherontia's nestlings told,  
By all in Bantine glade that dwell,  
Or till the rich Forentan mould.  
“Bears, vipers, spared him as he lay,  
The sacred garland deck'd his hair,  
The myrtle blended with the bay:  
The child's inspired: the gods were there.”  
Your grace, sweet Muses, shields me still  
On Sabine heights, or lets me range  
Where cool Praeneste, Tibur's hill,  
Or liquid Baiae proffers change.  
Me to your springs, your dances true,  
Philippi bore not to the ground,  
Nor the doom'd tree in falling slew,  
Nor billowy Palinurus drown'd.  
Grant me your presence, blithe and fain  
Mad Bosporus shall my bark explore;  
My foot shall tread the sandy plain  
That glows beside Assyria's shore;  
'Mid Briton tribes, the stranger's foe,  
And Spaniards, drunk with horses' blood,  
And quiver'd Scythians, will I go  
Unharm'd, and look on Tanais' flood.  
When Caesar's self in peaceful town  
The weary veteran's home has made,  
You bid him lay his helmet down  
And rest in your Pierian shade.  
Mild thoughts you plant, and joy to see  
Mild thoughts take root. The nations know  
How with descending thunder he  
The impious Titans hurl'd below,  
Who rules dull earth and stormy seas,

And towns of men, and realms of pain,  
And gods, and mortal companies,  
Alone, impartial in his reign.  
Yet Jove had fear'd the giant rush,  
Their upraised arms, their port of pride,  
And the twin brethren bent to push  
Huge Pelion up Olympus' side.  
But Typhon, Mimas, what could these,  
Or what Porphyryion's stalwart scorn,  
Rhoetus, or he whose spears were trees,  
Enceladus, from earth uptorn,  
As on they rush'd in mad career  
'Gainst Pallas' shield? Here met the foe  
Fierce Vulcan, queenly Juno here,  
And he who ne'er shall quit his bow,  
Who laves in clear Castalian flood  
His locks, and loves the leafy growth  
Of Lycia next his native wood,  
The Delian and the Pataran both.  
Strength, mindless, falls by its own weight;  
Strength, mix'd with mind, is made more strong  
By the just gods, who surely hate  
The strength whose thoughts are set on wrong.  
Let hundred-handed Gias bear  
His witness, and Orion known  
Tempter of Dian, chaste and fair,  
By Dian's maiden dart o'erthrown.  
Hurl'd on the monstrous shapes she bred,  
Earth groans, and mourns her children thrust  
To Orcus; Aetna's weight of lead  
Keeps down the fire that breaks its crust;  
Still sits the bird on Tityos' breast,  
The warder of Unlawful love;

Still suffers lewd Pirithous, prest  
By massive chains no hand may move.

## V. Caelo tonantem credidimus Iovem

3.5

Jove rules in heaven, his thunder shows;  
Henceforth Augustus earth shall own  
Her present god, now Briton foes  
And Persians bow before his throne.  
Has Crassus' soldier ta'en to wife  
A base barbarian, and grown grey  
(Woe, for a nation's tainted life!)  
Earning his foemen-kinsmen's pay,  
His king, forsooth, a Mede, his sire  
A Marsian? can he name forget,  
Gown, sacred shield, undying fire,  
And Jove and Rome are standing yet?  
'Twas this that Regulus foresaw,  
What time he spurn'd the foul disgrace  
Of peace, whose precedent would draw  
Destruction on an unborn race,  
Should aught but death the prisoner's chain  
Unrivet. "I have seen," he said,  
"Rome's eagle in a Punic fane,  
And armour, ne'er a blood-drop shed,  
Stripp'd from the soldier; I have seen  
Free sons of Rome with arms fast tied;  
The fields we spoil'd with corn are green,  
And Carthage opes her portals wide.  
The warrior, sure, redeem'd by gold,  
Will fight the bolder! Aye, you heap  
On baseness loss. The hues of old  
Revisit not the wool we steep;

And genuine worth, expell'd by fear,  
 Returns not to the worthless slave.  
 Break but her meshes, will the deer  
 Assail you? then will he be brave  
 Who once to faithless foes has knelt;  
 Yes, Carthage yet his spear will fly,  
 Who with bound arms the cord has felt,  
 The coward, and has fear'd to die.  
 He knows not, he, how life is won;  
 Thinks war, like peace, a thing of trade!  
 Great art thou, Carthage! mate the sun,  
 While Italy in dust is laid!"

His wife's pure kiss he waved aside,  
 And prattling boys, as one disgraced,  
 They tell us, and with manly pride  
 Stern on the ground his visage placed.  
 With counsel thus ne'er else aread  
 He nerved the fathers' weak intent,  
 And, girt by friends that mourn'd him, sped  
 Into illustrious banishment.

Well witting what the torturer's art  
 Design'd him, with like unconcern  
 The press of kin he push'd apart  
 And crowds encumbering his return,  
 As though, some tedious business o'er  
 Of clients' court, his journey lay  
 Towards Venafrum's grassy floor,  
 Or Sparta-built Tarentum's bay.

## VI. Delicta maiorum inmeritus lues

3.6

Your fathers' guilt you still must pay,  
 Till, Roman, you restore each shrine,

Each temple, mouldering in decay,  
And smoke-grimed statue, scarce divine.  
Revering Heaven, you rule below;  
Be that your base, your coping still;  
'Tis Heaven neglected bids o'erflow  
The measure of Italian ill.  
Now Pacorus and Monaeses twice  
Have given our unblest arms the foil;  
Their necklaces, of mean device,  
Smiling they deck with Roman spoil.  
Our city, torn by faction's throes,  
Dacian and Ethiop well-nigh razed,  
These with their dreadful navy, those  
For archer-prowess rather praised.  
An evil age erewhile debased  
The marriage-bed, the race, the home;  
Thence rose the flood whose waters waste  
The nation and the name of Rome.  
Not such their birth, who stain'd for us  
The sea with Punic carnage red,  
Smote Pyrrhus, smote Antiochus,  
And Hannibal, the Roman's dread.  
Theirs was a hardy soldier-brood,  
Inured all day the land to till  
With Sabine spade, then shoulder wood  
Hewn at a stern old mother's will,  
When sunset lengthen'd from each height  
The shadows, and unyoked the steer,  
Restoring in its westward flight  
The hour to toilworn travail dear.  
What has not cankering Time made worse?  
Viler than grandsires, sires beget

Ourselves, yet baser, soon to curse  
The world with offspring baser yet.

VII. Quid fles, Asterie, quem tibi, candidi

3.7

Why weep for him whom sweet Favonian airs  
Will waft next spring, Asteria, back to you,  
Rich with Bithynia's wares,  
A lover fond and true,

Your Gyges? He, detain'd by stormy stress  
At Oricum, about the Goat-star's rise,  
Cold, wakeful, comfortless,  
The long night weeping lies.

Meantime his lovesick hostess' messenger  
Talks of the flames that waste poor Chloe's heart  
(Flames lit for you, not her!)  
With a besieger's art;

Shows how a treacherous woman's lying breath  
Once on a time on trustful Proetus won  
To doom to early death  
Too chaste Bellerophon;

Warns him of Peleus' peril, all but slain  
For virtuous scorn of fair Hippolyta,  
And tells again each tale  
That e'er led heart astray.

In vain; for deafer than Icarian seas  
He hears, untainted yet. But, lady fair,  
What if Enipeus please

Your listless eye? beware!

Though true it be that none with surer seat  
O'er Mars's grassy turf is seen to ride,  
Nor any swims so fleet  
Adown the Tuscan tide,

Yet keep each evening door and window barr'd;  
Look not abroad when music strikes up shrill,  
And though he call you hard,  
Remain obdurate still.

VIII. Martiis caelebs quid agam kalendis

3.8

The first of March! a man unwed!  
What can these flowers, this censer mean?  
Or what these embers, glowing red  
On sods of green?

You ask, in either language skill'd!  
A feast I vow'd to Bacchus free,  
A white he-goat, when all but kill'd  
By falling tree.

So, when that holyday comes round,  
It sees me still the rosin clear  
From this my wine-jar, first embrown'd  
In Tullus' year.

Come, crush one hundred cups for life  
Preserved, Maecenas; keep till day  
The candles lit; let noise and strife  
Be far away.

Lay down that load of state-concern;  
 The Dacian hosts are all o'erthrown;  
 The Mede, that sought our overturn,  
 Now seeks his own;

A servant now, our ancient foe,  
 The Spaniard, wears at last our chain;  
 The Scythian half unbends his bow  
 And quits the plain.

Then fret not lest the state should ail;  
 A private man such thoughts may spare;  
 Enjoy the present hour's regale,  
 And banish care.

#### IX. Donec gratus eram tibi

3,9

**HORACE:** While I had power to bless you,  
 Nor any round that neck his arms did fling  
 More privileged to caress you,  
 Happier was Horace than the Persian king.

**LYDIA:** While you for none were pining  
 Soror, nor Lydia after Chloe came,  
 Lydia, her peers outshining,  
 Might match her own with Ilia's Roman fame.

**HORACE:** Now Chloe is my treasure,  
 Whose voice, whose touch, can make sweet music flow:  
 For her I'd die with pleasure,  
 Would Fate but spare the dear survivor so.

**LYDIA:** I love my own fond lover,  
 Young Calais, son of Thurian Ornytus:

For him I'd die twice over,  
Would Fate but spare the sweet survivor thus.

**HORACE:** What now, if Love returning  
Should pair us 'neath his brazen yoke once more,  
And, bright-hair'd Chloe spurning,  
Horace to off-cast Lydia ope his door?

**LYDIA:** Though he is fairer, milder,  
Than starlight, you lighter than bark of tree,  
Than stormy Hadria wilder,  
With you to live, to die, were bliss for me.

#### X. Extremum Tanain si biberes, Lyce

3.10

Ah Lyce! though your drink were Tanais,  
Your husband some rude savage, you would weep  
To leave me shivering, on a night like this,  
Where storms their watches keep.

Hark! how your door is creaking! how the grove  
In your fair court-yard, while the wild winds blow,  
Wails in accord! with what transporence Jove  
Is glazing the driven snow!

Cease that proud temper: Venus loves it not:  
The rope may break, the wheel may backward turn:  
Begetting you, no Tuscan sire begot  
Penelope the stern.

O, though no gift, no "prevalence of prayer,"  
Nor lovers' paleness deep as violet,  
Nor husband, smit with a Pierian fair,  
Move you, have pity yet!

O harder e'en than toughest heart of oak,  
Deafer than uncharm'd snake to suppliant moans!  
This side, I warn you, will not always brook  
Rain-water and cold stones.

XI. Mercuri, nam te docilis magistro

3.11

Come, Mercury, by whose minstrel spell  
Amphion raised the Theban stones,  
Come, with thy seven sweet strings, my shell,  
Thy "diverse tones,"

Nor vocal once nor pleasant, now  
To rich man's board and temple dear:  
Put forth thy power, till Lyde bow  
Her stubborn ear.

She, like a three-year colt unbroke,  
Is frisking o'er the spacious plain,  
Too shy to bear a lover's yoke,  
A husband's rein.

The wood, the tiger, at thy call  
Have follow'd: thou canst rivers stay:  
The monstrous guard of Pluto's hall  
To thee gave way,

Grim Cerberus, round whose Gorgon head  
A hundred snakes are hissing death,  
Whose triple jaws black venom shed,  
And sickening breath.

Ixion too and Tityos smooth'd  
Their rugged brows: the urn stood dry  
One hour, while Danaus' maids were sooth'd  
With minstrelsy.

Let Lyde hear those maidens' guilt,  
Their famous doom, the ceaseless drain  
Of outpour'd water, ever spilt,  
And all the pain

Reserved for sinners, e'en when dead:  
Those impious hands, (could crime do more?)  
Those impious hands had hearts to shed  
Their bridegrooms' gore!

One only, true to Hymen's flame,  
Was traitress to her sire forsworn:  
That splendid falsehood lights her name  
Through times unborn.

“Wake!” to her youthful spouse she cried,  
“Wake! or you yet may sleep too well:  
Fly—from the father of your bride,  
Her sisters fell:

They, as she-lions bullocks rend,  
Tear each her victim: I, less hard  
Than these, will slay you not, poor friend,  
Nor hold in ward:

Me let my sire in fetters lay  
For mercy to my husband shown:  
Me let him ship far hence away,

To climes unknown.

Go; speed your flight o'er land and wave,  
While Night and Venus shield you; go  
Be blest: and on my tomb engrave  
This tale of woe."

## XII. Miserarum est neque amori dare ludum neque dulci

3.12

How unhappy are the maidens who with Cupid may not play,  
Who may never touch the wine-cup, but must tremble all the day  
At an uncle, and the scourging of his tongue!  
Neobule, there's a robber takes your needle and your thread,  
Lets the lessons of Minerva run no longer in your head;  
It is Hebrus, the athletic and the young!  
O, to see him when anointed he is plunging in the flood!  
What a seat he has on horseback! was Bellerophon's as good?  
As a boxer, as a runner, past compare!  
When the deer are flying blindly all the open country o'er,  
He can aim and he can hit them; he can steal upon the boar,  
As it couches in the thicket unaware.

## XIII. O fons Bandusiae splendidior vitro

3.13

Bandusia's fount, in clearness crystalline,  
O worthy of the wine, the flowers we vow!  
To-morrow shall be thine  
A kid, whose crescent brow

Is sprouting all for love and victory.  
In vain: his warm red blood, so early stirr'd,  
Thy gelid stream shall dye,  
Child of the wanton herd.

Thee the fierce Sirian star, to madness fired,  
Forbears to touch: sweet cool thy waters yield  
To ox with ploughing tired,  
And lazy sheep afield.

Thou too one day shalt win proud eminence  
'Mid honour'd founts, while I the ilex sing  
Crowning the cavern, whence  
Thy babbling wavelets spring.

#### XIV. Herculis ritu modo dictus, o plebs

3.14

Our Hercules, they told us, Rome,  
Had sought the laurel Death bestows:  
Now Glory brings him conqueror home  
From Spaniard foes.

Proud of her spouse, the imperial fair  
Must thank the gods that shield from death;  
His sister too:—let matrons wear  
The suppliant wreath

For daughters and for sons restored:  
Ye youths and damsels newly wed,  
Let decent awe restrain each word  
Best left unsaid.

This day, true holyday to me,  
Shall banish care: I will not fear  
Rude broils or bloody death to see,  
While Caesar's here.

Quick, boy, the chaplets and the nard,  
And wine, that knew the Marsian war,  
If roving Spartacus have spared  
A single jar.

And bid Neaera come and trill,  
Her bright locks bound with careless art:  
If her rough porter cross your will,  
Why then depart.

Soon palls the taste for noise and fray,  
When hair is white and leaves are sere:  
How had I fired in life's warm May,  
In Plancus' year!

#### XV. Uxor pauperis Ibyci

3.15

Wife of Ibycus the poor,  
Let aged scandals have at length their bound:  
Give your graceless doings o'er,  
Ripe as you are for going underground.  
You the maidens' dance to lead,  
And cast your gloom upon those beaming stars!  
Daughter Pholoe may succeed,  
But mother Chloris what she touches mars.  
Young men's homes your daughter storms,  
Like Thyiad, madden'd by the cymbals' beat:  
Nothus' love her bosom warms:  
She gambols like a fawn with silver feet.  
Yours should be the wool that grows  
By fair Luceria, not the merry lute:  
Flowers beseem not wither'd brows,  
Nor wither'd lips with emptied wine-jars suit.

## XVI. Inclusam Danaen turris aenea

3.16

Full well had Danae been secured, in truth,  
By oaken portals, and a brazen tower,  
And savage watch-dogs, from the roving youth  
That prowl at midnight's hour:

But Jove and Venus mock'd with gay disdain  
The jealous warder of that close stronghold:  
The way, they knew, must soon be smooth and plain  
When gods could change to gold.

Gold, gold can pass the tyrant's sentinel,  
Can shiver rocks with more resistless blow  
Than is the thunder's. Argos' prophet fell,  
He and his house laid low,

And all for gain. The man of Macedon  
Cleft gates of cities, rival kings o'erthrew  
By force of gifts: their cunning snares have won  
Rude captains and their crew.

As riches grow, care follows: men repine  
And thirst for more. No lofty crest I raise:  
Wisdom that thought forbids, Maecenas mine,  
The knightly order's praise.

He that denies himself shall gain the more  
From bounteous Heaven. I strip me of my pride,  
Desert the rich man's standard, and pass o'er  
To bare Contentment's side,

More proud as lord of what the great despise

Than if the wheat thresh'd on Apulia's floor  
I hoarded all in my huge granaries,  
'Mid vast possessions poor.

A clear fresh stream, a little field o'ergrown  
With shady trees, a crop that ne'er deceives,  
Pass, though men know it not, their wealth, that own  
All Afric's golden sheaves.

Though no Calabrian bees their honey yield  
For me, nor mellowing sleeps the god of wine  
In Formian jar, nor in Gaul's pasture-field  
The wool grows long and fine,

Yet Poverty ne'er comes to break my peace;  
If more I craved, you would not more refuse.  
Desiring less, I better shall increase  
My tiny revenues,

Than if to Alyattes' wide domains  
I join'd the realms of Mygdon. Great desires  
Sort with great wants. 'Tis best, when prayer obtains  
No more than life requires.

## XVII. Aeli vetusto nobilis ab Lamo

3.17

Aelius, of Lamus' ancient name  
(For since from that high parentage  
The prehistoric Lamias came  
And all who fill the storied page,  
No doubt you trace your line from him,  
Who stretch'd his sway o'er Formiae,  
And Liris, whose still waters swim

Where green Marica skirts the sea,  
Lord of broad realms), an eastern gale  
Will blow to-morrow, and bestrew  
The shore with weeds, with leaves the vale,  
If rain's old prophet tell me true,  
The raven. Gather, while 'tis fine,  
Your wood; to-morrow shall be gay  
With smoking pig and streaming wine,  
And lord and slave keep holyday.

XVIII. Faune, Nympharum fugientum amator

3.18

O wont the flying Nymphs to woo,  
Good Faunus, through my sunny farm  
Pass gently, gently pass, nor do  
My younglings harm.

Each year, thou know'st, a kid must die  
For thee; nor lacks the wine's full stream  
To Venus' mate, the bowl; and high  
The altars steam.

Sure as December's Nones appear,  
All o'er the grass the cattle play;  
The village, with the lazy steer,  
Keeps holyday.

Wolves rove among the fearless sheep;  
The woods for thee their foliage strow;  
The delver loves on earth to leap,  
His ancient foe.

## XIX. Quantum distet ab Inacho

3.19

What the time from Inachus  
 To Codrus, who in patriot battle fell,  
 Who were sprung from Aeacus,  
 And how men fought at Ilion,—this you tell.  
 What the wines of Chios cost,  
 Who with due heat our water can allay,  
 What the hour, and who the host  
 To give us house-room,—this you will not say.  
 Ho, there! wine to moonrise, wine  
 To midnight, wine to our new augur too!  
 Nine to three or three to nine,  
 As each man pleases, makes proportion true.  
 Who the uneven Muses loves,  
 Will fire his dizzy brain with three times three;  
 Three once told the Grace approves;  
 She with her two bright sisters, gay and free,  
 Shrinks, as maiden should, from strife:  
 But I'm for madness. What has dull'd the fire  
 Of the Berecyntian fife?  
 Why hangs the flute in silence with the lyre?  
 Out on niggard-handed boys!  
 Rain showers of roses; let old Lycus hear,  
 Envious churl, our senseless noise,  
 And she, our neighbour, his ill-sorted fere.  
 You with your bright clustering hair,  
 Your beauty, Telephus, like evening's sky,  
 Rhoda loves, as young, as fair;  
 I for my Glycera slowly, slowly die.

## XXI. O nata mecum consule Manlio

3.21

O born in Manlius' year with me,  
 Whate'er you bring us, plaint or jest,  
 Or passion and wild revelry,  
 Or, like a gentle wine-jar, rest;  
 Howe'er men call your Massic juice,  
 Its broaching claims a festal day;  
 Come then; Corvinus bids produce  
 A mellower wine, and I obey.  
 Though steep'd in all Socratic lore  
 He will not slight you; do not fear.  
 They say old Cato o'er and o'er  
 With wine his honest heart would cheer.  
 Tough wits to your mild torture yield  
 Their treasures; you unlock the soul  
 Of wisdom and its stores conceal'd,  
 Arm'd with Lyaeus' kind control.  
 'Tis yours the drooping heart to heal;  
 Your strength uplifts the poor man's horn;  
 Inspired by you, the soldier's steel,  
 The monarch's crown, he laughs to scorn.  
 Liber and Venus, wills she so,  
 And sister Graces, ne'er unknit,  
 And living lamps shall see you flow  
 Till stars before the sunrise flit.

## XXII. Montium custos nemorumque, virgo

3.22

Guardian of hill and woodland, Maid,  
 Who to young wives in childbirth's hour  
 Thrice call'd, vouchsafest sovereign aid,  
 O three-form'd power!

This pine that shades my cot be thine;

Here will I slay, as years come round,  
A youngling boar, whose tusks design  
The side-long wound.

XXIII. Caelo supinas si tuleris manus

3.23

If, Phidyle, your hands you lift  
To heaven, as each new moon is born,  
Soothing your Lares with the gift  
Of slaughter'd swine, and spice, and corn,  
Ne'er shall Scirocco's bane assail  
Your vines, nor mildew blast your wheat.  
Ne'er shall your tender younglings fail  
In autumn, when the fruits are sweet.  
The destined victim 'mid the snows  
Of Algidus in oakwoods fed,  
Or where the Alban herbage grows,  
Shall dye the pontiff's axes red;  
No need of butcher'd sheep for you  
To make your homely prayers prevail;  
Give but your little gods their due,  
The rosemary twined with myrtle frail.  
The sprinkled salt, the votive meal,  
As soon their favour will regain,  
Let but the hand be pure and leal,  
As all the pomp of heifers slain.

XXIV. Intactis opulentior

3.24

Though your buried wealth surpass  
The unsunn'd gold of Ind or Araby,  
Though with many a ponderous mass  
You crowd the Tuscan and Apulian sea,

Let Necessity but drive  
Her wedge of adamant into that proud head,  
Vainly battling will you strive  
To 'scape Death's noose, or rid your soul of dread.  
Better life the Scythians lead,  
Trailing on waggon wheels their wandering home,  
Or the hardy Getan breed,  
As o'er their vast unmeasured steppes they roam;  
Free the crops that bless their soil;  
Their tillage wearies after one year's space;  
Each in turn fulfils his toil;  
His period o'er, another takes his place.  
There the step-dame keeps her hand  
From guilty plots, from blood of orphans clean;  
There no dowried wives command  
Their feeble lords, or on adulterers lean.  
Theirs are dowries not of gold,  
Their parents' worth, their own pure chastity,  
True to one, to others cold;  
They dare not sin, or, if they dare, they die.  
O, whoe'er has heart and head  
To stay our plague of blood, our civic brawls,  
Would he that his name be read  
"Father of Rome" on lofty pedestals,  
Let him chain this lawless will,  
And be our children's hero! cursed spite!  
Living worth we envy still,  
Then seek it with strain'd eyes, when snatch'd from sight.  
What can sad laments avail  
Unless sharp justice kill the taint of sin?  
What can laws, that needs must fail  
Shorn of the aid of manners form'd within,  
If the merchant turns not back

From the fierce heats that round the tropic glow,  
Turns not from the regions black  
With northern winds, and hard with frozen snow;  
Sailors override the wave,  
While guilty poverty, more fear'd than vice,  
Bids us crime and suffering brave,  
And shuns the ascent of virtue's precipice?  
Let the Capitolian fane,  
The favour'd goal of yon vociferous crowd,  
Aye, or let the nearest main  
Receive our gold, our jewels rich and proud:  
Slay we thus the cause of crime,  
If yet we would repent and choose the good:  
Ours the task to take in time  
This baleful lust, and crush it in the bud.  
Ours to mould our weakling sons  
To nobler sentiment and manlier deed:  
Now the noble's first-born shuns  
The perilous chase, nor learns to sit his steed:  
Set him to the unlawful dice,  
Or Grecian hoop, how skilfully he plays!  
While his sire, mature in vice,  
A friend, a partner, or a guest betrays,  
Hurrying, for an heir so base,  
To gather riches. Money, root of ill,  
Doubt it not, still grows apace:  
Yet the scant heap has somewhat lacking still.

XXV. Quo me, Bacche, rapis tui

3.25

Whither, Bacchus, tear'st thou me,  
Fill'd with thy strength? What dens, what forests these,  
Thus in wildering race I see?

What cave shall hearken to my melodies,  
Tuned to tell of Caesar's praise  
And throne him high the heavenly ranks among?  
Sweet and strange shall be my lays,  
A tale till now by poet voice unsung.  
As the Evian on the height,  
Roused from her sleep, looks wonderingly abroad,  
Looks on Thrace with snow-drifts white,  
And Rhodope by barbarous footstep trod,  
So my truant eyes admire  
The banks, the desolate forests. O great King  
Who the Naiads dost inspire,  
And Bacchantes, strong from earth huge trees to wring!  
Not a lowly strain is mine,  
No mere man's utterance. O, 'tis venture sweet  
Thee to follow, God of wine,  
Making the vine-branch round thy temples meet!

XXVI. Vixi puellis nuper idoneus

3.26

For ladies' love I late was fit,  
And good success my warfare blest,  
But now my arms, my lyre I quit,  
And hang them up to rust or rest.  
Here, where arising from the sea  
Stands Venus, lay the load at last,  
Links, crowbars, and artillery,  
Threatening all doors that dared be fast.  
O Goddess! Cyprus owns thy sway,  
And Memphis, far from Thracian snow;  
Raise high thy lash, and deal me, pray,  
That haughty Chloe just one blow!

## XXVII. Inpios parrae recinentis omen

3.27

When guilt goes forth, let lapwings shrill,  
And dogs and foxes great with young,  
And wolves from far Lanuvian hill,  
Give clamorous tongue:

Across the roadway dart the snake,  
Frightening, like arrow loosed from string,  
The horses. I, for friendship's sake,  
Watching each wing,

Ere to his haunt, the stagnant marsh,  
The harbinger of tempest flies,  
Will call the raven, croaking harsh,  
From eastern skies.

Farewell!—and wheresoe'er you go,  
My Galatea, think of me:  
Let lefthand pie and roving crow  
Still leave you free.

But mark with what a front of fear  
Orion lowers. Ah! well I know  
How Hadria glooms, how falsely clear  
The west-winds blow.

Let foemen's wives and children feel  
The gathering south-wind's angry roar,  
The black wave's crash, the thunder-peal,  
The quivering shore.

So to the bull Europa gave

Her beauteous form, and when she saw  
The monstrous deep, the yawning grave,  
Grew pale with awe.

That morn of meadow-flowers she thought,  
Weaving a crown the nymphs to please:  
That gloomy night she look'd on nought  
But stars and seas.

Then, as in hundred-citied Crete  
She landed,—“O my sire!” she said,  
“O childly duty! passion's heat  
Has struck thee dead.

Whence came I? death, for maiden's shame,  
Were little. Do I wake to weep  
My sin? or am I pure of blame,  
And is it sleep

From dreamland brings a form to trick  
My senses? Which was best? to go  
Over the long, long waves, or pick  
The flowers in blow?

O, were that monster made my prize,  
How would I strive to wound that brow,  
How tear those horns, my frantic eyes  
Adored but now!

Shameless I left my father's home;  
Shameless I cheat the expectant grave;  
O heaven, that naked I might roam  
In lions' cave!

Now, ere decay my bloom devour  
Or thin the richness of my blood,  
Fain would I fall in youth's first flower,  
The tigers' food.

Hark! 'tis my father—'Worthless one!  
What, yet alive? the oak is nigh.  
'Twas well you kept your maiden zone,  
The noose to tie.

Or if your choice be that rude pike,  
New barb'd with death, leap down and ask  
The wind to bear you. Would you like  
The bondmaid's task,

You, child of kings, a master's toy,  
A mistress' slave?" Beside her, lo!  
Stood Venus smiling, and her boy  
With unstrung bow.

Then, when her laughter ceased, "Have done  
With fume and fret," she cried, "my fair;  
That odious bull will give you soon  
His horns to tear.

You know not you are Jove's own dame:  
Away with sobbing; be resign'd  
To greatness: you shall give your name  
To half mankind."

## XXVIII. Festo quid potius die

Neptune's feast-day! what should man  
 Think first of doing? Lyde mine, be bold,  
 Broach the treasured Caecuban,  
 And batter Wisdom in her own stronghold.  
 Now the noon has pass'd the full,  
 Yet sure you deem swift Time has made a halt,  
 Tardy as you are to pull  
 Old Bibulus' wine-jar from its sleepy vault.  
 I will take my turn and sing  
 Neptune and Nereus' train with locks of green;  
 You shall warble to the string  
 Latona and her Cynthia's arrowy sheen.  
 Hers our latest song, who sways  
 Cnidos and Cyclads, and to Paphos goes  
 With her swans, on holydays;  
 Night too shall claim the homage music owes.

### XXIX. Tyrrhena regum progenies, tibi

3.29

Heir of Tyrrhenian kings, for you  
 A mellow cask, unbroach'd as yet,  
 Maecenas mine, and roses new,  
 And fresh-drawn oil your locks to wet,  
 Are waiting here. Delay not still,  
 Nor gaze on Tibur, never dried,  
 And sloping Aesule, and the hill  
 Of Telegon the parricide.  
 O leave that pomp that can but tire,  
 Those piles, among the clouds at home;  
 Cease for a moment to admire  
 The smoke, the wealth, the noise of Rome!  
 In change e'en luxury finds a zest:  
 The poor man's supper, neat, but spare,

With no gay couch to seat the guest,  
Has smooth'd the rugged brow of care.  
Now glows the Ethiop maiden's sire;  
Now Procyon rages all ablaze;  
The Lion maddens in his ire,  
As suns bring back the sultry days:  
The shepherd with his weary sheep  
Seeks out the streamlet and the trees,  
Silvanus' lair: the still banks sleep  
Untroubled by the wandering breeze.  
You ponder on imperial schemes,  
And o'er the city's danger brood:  
Bactrian and Serian haunt your dreams,  
And Tanais, toss'd by inward feud.  
The issue of the time to be  
Heaven wisely hides in blackest night,  
And laughs, should man's anxiety  
Transgress the bounds of man's short sight.  
Control the present: all beside  
Flows like a river seaward borne,  
Now rolling on its placid tide,  
Now whirling massy trunks uptorn,  
And waveworn crags, and farms, and stock,  
In chaos blent, while hill and wood  
Reverberate to the enormous shock,  
When savage rains the tranquil flood  
Have stirr'd to madness. Happy he,  
Self-centred, who each night can say,  
"My life is lived: the morn may see  
A clouded or a sunny day:  
That rests with Jove: but what is gone,  
He will not, cannot turn to nought;  
Nor cancel, as a thing undone,

What once the flying hour has brought.”  
 Fortune, who loves her cruel game,  
 Still bent upon some heartless whim,  
 Shifts her caresses, fickle dame,  
 Now kind to me, and now to him:  
 She stays; 'tis well: but let her shake  
 Those wings, her presents I resign,  
 Cloak me in native worth, and take  
 Chaste Poverty undower'd for mine.  
 Though storms around my vessel rave,  
 I will not fall to craven prayers,  
 Nor bargain by my vows to save  
 My Cyprian and Sidonian wares,  
 Else added to the insatiate main.  
 Then through the wild Aegean roar  
 The breezes and the Brethren Twain  
 Shall waft my little boat ashore.

### XXX. Exegi monumentum aere perennius

3.30

And now 'tis done: more durable than brass  
 My monument shall be, and raise its head  
 O'er royal pyramids: it shall not dread  
 Corroding rain or angry Boreas,

Nor the long lapse of immemorial time.  
 I shall not wholly die: large residue  
 Shall 'scape the queen of funerals. Ever new  
 My after fame shall grow, while pontiffs climb

With silent maids the Capitolian height.  
 “Born,” men will say, “where Aufidus is loud,  
 Where Daunus, scant of streams, beneath him bow'd

The rustic tribes, from dimness he wax'd bright,

First of his race to wed the Aeolian lay  
To notes of Italy." Put glory on,  
My own Melpomene, by genius won,  
And crown me of thy grace with Delphic bay.

## Book IV

### I. Intermissa, Venus, diu

4.1

Yet again thou wak'st the flame  
That long had slumber'd! Spare me, Venus, spare!  
Trust me, I am not the same  
As in the reign of Cinara, kind and fair.  
Cease thy softening spells to prove  
On this old heart, by fifty years made hard,  
Cruel Mother of sweet Love!  
Haste, where gay youth solicits thy regard.  
With thy purple cygnets fly  
To Paullus' door, a seasonable guest;  
There within hold revelry,  
There light thy flame in that congenial breast.  
He, with birth and beauty graced,  
The trembling client's champion, ne'er tongue-tied,  
Master of each manly taste,  
Shall bear thy conquering banners far and wide.  
Let him smile in triumph gay,  
True heart, victorious over lavish hand,  
By the Alban lake that day  
'Neath citron roof all marble shalt thou stand:  
Incense there and fragrant spice  
With odorous fumes thy nostrils shall salute;

Blended notes thine ear entice,  
 The lyre, the pipe, the Berecynthine flute:  
 Graceful youths and maidens bright  
 Shall twice a day thy tuneful praise resound,  
 While their feet, so fair and white,  
 In Salian measure three times beat the ground.  
 I can relish love no more,  
 Nor flattering hopes that tell me hearts are true,  
 Nor the revel's loud uproar,  
 Nor fresh-wreathed flowerets, bathed in vernal dew.  
 Ah! but why, my Ligurine,  
 Steal trickling tear-drops down my wasted cheek?  
 Wherefore halts this tongue of mine,  
 So eloquent once, so faltering now and weak?  
 Now I hold you in my chain,  
 And clasp you close, all in a nightly dream;  
 Now, still dreaming, o'er the plain  
 I chase you; now, ah cruel! down the stream.

## II. Pindarum quisquis studet aemulari

4.2

Who fain at Pindar's flight would aim,  
 On waxen wings, Iulus, he  
 Soars heavenward, doom'd to give his name  
 To some new sea.

Pindar, like torrent from the steep  
 Which, swollen with rain, its banks o'erflows,  
 With mouth unfathomably deep,  
 Foams, thunders, glows,

All worthy of Apollo's bay,  
 Whether in dithyrambic roll

Pouring new words he burst away  
Beyond control,

Or gods and god-born heroes tell,  
Whose arm with righteous death could tame  
Grim Centaurs, tame Chimaeras fell,  
Out-breathing flame,

Or bid the boxer or the steed  
In deathless pride of victory live,  
And dower them with a nobler meed  
Than sculptors give,

Or mourn the bridegroom early torn  
From his young bride, and set on high  
Strength, courage, virtue's golden morn,  
Too good to die.

Antonius! yes, the winds blow free,  
When Dirce's swan ascends the skies,  
To waft him. I, like Matine bee,  
In act and guise,

That culls its sweets through toilsome hours,  
Am roaming Tibur's banks along,  
And fashioning with puny powers  
A laboured song.

Your Muse shall sing in loftier strain  
How Caesar climbs the sacred height,  
The fierce Sygambrians in his train,  
With laurel dight,

Than whom the Fates ne'er gave mankind  
A richer treasure or more dear,  
Nor shall, though earth again should find  
The golden year.

Your Muse shall tell of public sports,  
And holyday, and votive feast,  
For Caesar's sake, and brawling courts  
Where strife has ceased.

Then, if my voice can aught avail,  
Grateful for him our prayers have won,  
My song shall echo, "Hail, all hail,  
Auspicious Sun!"

There as you move, "Ho! Triumph, ho!  
Great Triumph!" once and yet again  
All Rome shall cry, and spices strow  
Before your train.

Ten bulls, ten kine, your debt discharge:  
A calf new-wean'd from parent cow,  
Battening on pastures rich and large,  
Shall quit my vow.

Like moon just dawning on the night  
The crescent honours of his head;  
One dapple spot of snowy white,  
The rest all red.

### III. Quem tu, Melpomene, semel

He whom thou, Melpomene,  
Hast welcomed with thy smile, in life arriving,  
Ne'er by boxer's skill shall be  
Renown'd abroad, for Isthmian mastery striving;  
Him shall never fiery steed  
Draw in Achaean car a conqueror seated;  
Him shall never martial deed  
Show, crown'd with bay, after proud kings defeated,  
Climbing Capitolian steep:  
But the cool streams that make green Tibur flourish,  
And the tangled forest deep,  
On soft Aeolian airs his fame shall nourish.  
Rome, of cities first and best,  
Deigns by her sons' according voice to hail me  
Fellow-bard of poets blest,  
And faint and fainter envy's growls assail me.  
Goddess, whose Pierian art  
The lyre's sweet sounds can modulate and measure,  
Who to dumb fish canst impart  
The music of the swan, if such thy pleasure:  
O, 'tis all of thy dear grace  
That every finger points me out in going  
Lyrist of the Roman race;  
Breath, power to charm, if mine, are thy bestowing!

#### IV. Qualem ministrum fulminis alitem

4.4

E'en as the lightning's minister,  
Whom Jove o'er all the feather'd breed  
Made sovereign, having proved him sure  
Erewhile on auburn Ganymede;  
Stirr'd by warm youth and inborn power,  
He quits the nest with timorous wing,

For winter's storms have ceased to lower,  
And zephyrs of returning spring  
Tempt him to launch on unknown skies;  
Next on the fold he stoops downright;  
Last on resisting serpents flies,  
Athirst for foray and for flight:  
As tender kidling on the grass  
Espies, uplooking from her food,  
A lion's whelp, and knows, alas!  
Those new-set teeth shall drink her blood:  
So look'd the Raetian mountaineers  
On Drusus:—whence in every field  
They learn'd through immemorial years  
The Amazonian axe to wield,  
I ask not now: not all of truth  
We seekers find: enough to know  
The wisdom of the princely youth  
Has taught our erst victorious foe  
What prowess dwells in boyish hearts  
Rear'd in the shrine of a pure home,  
What strength Augustus' love imparts  
To Nero's seed, the hope of Rome.  
Good sons and brave good sires approve:  
Strong bullocks, fiery colts, attest  
Their fathers' worth, nor weakling dove  
Is hatch'd in savage eagle's nest.  
But care draws forth the power within,  
And cultured minds are strong for good:  
Let manners fail, the plague of sin  
Taints e'en the course of gentle blood.  
How great thy debt to Nero's race,  
O Rome, let red Metaurus say,  
Slain Hasdrubal, and victory's grace

First granted on that glorious day  
Which chased the clouds, and show'd the sun,  
When Hannibal o'er Italy  
Ran, as swift flames o'er pine-woods run,  
Or Eurus o'er Sicilia's sea.  
Henceforth, by fortune aiding toil,  
Rome's prowess grew: her fanes, laid waste  
By Punic sacrilege and spoil,  
Beheld at length their gods replaced.  
Then the false Libyan own'd his doom:—  
“Weak deer, the wolves' predestined prey,  
Blindly we rush on foes, from whom  
'Twere triumph won to steal away.  
That race which, strong from Ilion's fires,  
Its gods, on Tuscan waters tost,  
Its sons, its venerable sires,  
Bore to Ausonia's citied coast;  
That race, like oak by axes shorn  
On Algidus with dark leaves rife,  
Laughs carnage, havoc, all to scorn,  
And draws new spirit from the knife.  
Not the lopp'd Hydra task'd so sore  
Alcides, chafing at the foil:  
No pest so fell was born of yore  
From Colchian or from Theban soil.  
Plunged in the deep, it mounts to sight  
More splendid: grappled, it will quell  
Unbroken powers, and fight a fight  
Whose story widow'd wives shall tell.  
No heralds shall my deeds proclaim  
To Carthage now: lost, lost is all:  
A nation's hope, a nation's name,  
They died with dying Hasdrubal.”

What will not Claudian hands achieve?  
Jove's favour is their guiding star,  
And watchful potencies unweave  
For them the tangled paths of war.

V. Divis orte bonis, optume Romulae

4.5

Best guardian of Rome's people, dearest boon  
Of a kind Heaven, thou lingerest all too long:  
Thou bad'st thy senate look to meet thee soon:  
Do not thy promise wrong.

Restore, dear chief, the light thou tak'st away:  
Ah! when, like spring, that gracious mien of thine  
Dawns on thy Rome, more gently glides the day,  
And suns serener shine.

See her whose darling child a long year past  
Has dwelt beyond the wild Carpathian foam;  
That long year o'er, the envious southern blast  
Still bars him from his home:

Weeping and praying to the shore she clings,  
Nor ever thence her straining eyesight turns:  
So, smit by loyal passion's restless stings,  
Rome for her Caesar yearns.

In safety range the cattle o'er the mead:  
Sweet Peace, soft Plenty, swell the golden grain:  
O'er unvex'd seas the sailors blithely speed:  
Fair Honour shrinks from stain:

No guilty lusts the shrine of home defile:

Cleansed is the hand without, the heart within:  
The father's features in his children smile:  
Swift vengeance follows sin.

Who fears the Parthian or the Scythian horde,  
Or the rank growth that German forests yield,  
While Caesar lives? who trembles at the sword  
The fierce Iberians wield?

In his own hills each labours down the day,  
Teaching the vine to clasp the widow'd tree:  
Then to his cups again, where, feasting gay,  
He hails his god in thee.

A household power, adored with prayers and wine,  
Thou reign'st auspicious o'er his hour of ease:  
Thus grateful Greece her Castor made divine,  
And her great Hercules.

Ah! be it thine long holydays to give  
To thy Hesperia! thus, dear chief, we pray  
At sober sunrise; thus at mellow eve,  
When ocean hides the day.

#### VI. Dive, quem proles Niobeae magnae

4,6

Thou who didst make thy vengeful might  
To Niobe and Tityos known,  
And Peleus' son, when Troy's tall height  
Was nigh his own,

Victorious else, for thee no peer,  
Though, strong in his sea-parent's power,

He shook with that tremendous spear  
The Dardan tower.

He, like a pine by axes sped,  
Or cypress sway'd by angry gust,  
Fell ruining, and laid his head  
In Trojan dust.

Not his to lie in covert pent  
Of the false steed, and sudden fall  
On Priam's ill-starr'd merriment  
In bower and hall:

His ruthless arm in broad bare day  
The infant from the breast had torn,  
Nay, given to flame, ah, well a way!  
The babe unborn:

But, won by Venus' voice and thine,  
Relenting Jove Aeneas will'd  
With other omens more benign  
New walls to build.

Sweet tuner of the Grecian lyre,  
Whose locks are laved in Xanthus' dew,  
Blooming Agyeus! help, inspire  
My Daunian Muse!

'Tis Phoebus, Phoebus gifts my tongue  
With minstrel art and minstrel fires:  
Come, noble youths and maidens sprung  
From noble sires,

Blest in your Dian's guardian smile,  
Whose shafts the flying silvans stay,  
Come, foot the Lesbian measure, while  
The lyre I play:

Sing of Latona's glorious boy,  
Sing of night's queen with crescent horn,  
Who wings the fleeting months with joy,  
And swells the corn.

And happy brides shall say, "'Twas mine,  
When years the cyclic season brought,  
To chant the festal hymn divine  
By *Horace* taught."

## VII. Diffugere nives, redeunt iam gramina campis

4.7

The snow is fled: the trees their leaves put on,  
The fields their green:  
Earth owns the change, and rivers lessening run  
Their banks between.  
Naked the Nymphs and Graces in the meads  
The dance essay:  
"No 'scaping death" proclaims the year, that speeds  
This sweet spring day.  
Frosts yield to zephyrs; Summer drives out Spring,  
To vanish, when  
Rich Autumn sheds his fruits; round wheels the ring,—  
Winter again!  
Yet the swift moons repair Heaven's detriment:  
We, soon as thrust  
Where good Aeneas, Tullus, Ancus went,  
What are we? dust.

Can Hope assure you one more day to live  
 From powers above?  
 You rescue from your heir whate'er you give  
 The self you love.  
 When life is o'er, and Minos has rehearsed  
 The grand last doom,  
 Not birth, nor eloquence, nor worth, shall burst  
 Torquatus' tomb.  
 Not Dian's self can chaste Hippolytus  
 To life recall,  
 Nor Theseus free his loved Pirithous  
 From Lethe's thrall.

#### VIII. Donarem pateras grataque commodus

4.8

Ah Censorinus! to my comrades true  
 Rich cups, rare bronzes, gladly would I send:  
 Choice tripods from Olympia on each friend  
 Would I confer, choicer on none than you,  
  
 Had but my fate such gems of art bestow'd  
 As cunning Scopas or Parrhasius wrought,  
 This with the brush, that with the chisel taught  
 To image now a mortal, now a god.  
  
 But these are not my riches: your desire  
 Such luxury craves not, and your means disdain:  
 A poet's strain you love; a poet's strain  
 Accept, and learn the value of the lyre.  
  
 Not public gravings on a marble base,  
 Whence comes a second life to men of might  
 E'en in the tomb: not Hannibal's swift flight,

Nor those fierce threats flung back into his face,

Not impious Carthage in its last red blaze,  
In clearer light sets forth his spotless fame,  
Who from crush'd Afric took away—a name,  
Than rude Calabria's tributary lays.

Let silence hide the good your hand has wrought,  
Farewell, reward! Had blank oblivion's power  
Dimm'd the bright deeds of Romulus, at this hour,  
Despite his sire and mother, he were nought.

Thus Aeacus has 'scaped the Stygian wave,  
By grace of poets and their silver tongue,  
Henceforth to live the happy isles among.  
No, trust the Muse: she opes the good man's grave,

And lifts him to the gods. So Hercules,  
His labours o'er, sits at the board of Jove:  
So Tyndareus' offspring shine as stars above,  
Saving lorn vessels from the yawning seas:

So Bacchus, with the vine-wreath round his hair,  
Gives prosperous issue to his votary's prayer.

#### IX. Ne forte credas interitura quae

4.9

Think not those strains can e'er expire,  
Which, cradled 'mid the echoing roar  
Of Aufidus, to Latium's lyre  
I sing with arts unknown before.  
Though Homer fill the foremost throne,  
Yet grave Stesichorus still can please,

And fierce Alcaeus holds his own,  
With Pindar and Simonides.  
The songs of Teos are not mute,  
And Sappho's love is breathing still:  
She told her secret to the lute,  
And yet its chords with passion thrill.  
Not Sparta's queen alone was fired  
By broider'd robe and braided tress,  
And all the splendours that attired  
Her lover's guilty loveliness:  
Not only Teucer to the field  
His arrows brought, nor Iliion  
Beneath a single conqueror reel'd:  
Not Crete's majestic lord alone,  
Or Sthenelus, earn'd the Muses' crown:  
Not Hector first for child and wife,  
Or brave Deiphobus, laid down  
The burden of a manly life.  
Before Atrides men were brave:  
But ah! oblivion, dark and long,  
Has lock'd them in a tearless grave,  
For lack of consecrating song.  
'Twixt worth and baseness, lapp'd in death,  
What difference? *You* shall ne'er be dumb,  
While strains of mine have voice and breath:  
The dull neglect of days to come  
Those hard-won honours shall not blight:  
No, Lollius, no: a soul is yours,  
Clear-sighted, keen, alike upright  
When fortune smiles, and when she lowers:  
To greed and rapine still severe,  
Spurning the gain men find so sweet:  
A consul, not of one brief year,

But oft as on the judgment-seat  
You bend the expedient to the right,  
Turn haughty eyes from bribes away,  
Or bear your banners through the fight,  
Scattering the foeman's firm array.  
The lord of boundless revenues,  
Salute not him as happy: no,  
Call him the happy, who can use  
The bounty that the gods bestow,  
Can bear the load of poverty,  
And tremble not at death, but sin:  
No recreant he when called to die  
In cause of country or of kin.

XI. Est mihi nonum superantis annum

4.11

Here is a cask of Alban, more  
Than nine years old: here grows for you  
Green parsley, Phyllis, and good store  
Of ivy too

(Wreathed ivy suits your hair, you know):  
The plate shines bright: the altar, strew'd  
With vervain, hungers for the flow  
Of lambkin's blood.

There's stir among the serving folk;  
They bustle, bustle, boy and girl;  
The flickering flames send up the smoke  
In many a curl.

But why, you ask, this special cheer?  
We celebrate the feast of Ides,

Which April's month, to Venus dear,  
In twain divides.

O, 'tis a day for reverence,  
E'en my own birthday scarce so dear,  
For my Maecenas counts from thence  
Each added year.

'Tis Telephus that you'd bewitch:  
But he is of a high degree;  
Bound to a lady fair and rich,  
He is not free.

O think of Phaethon half burn'd,  
And moderate your passion's greed:  
Think how Bellerophon was spurn'd  
By his wing'd steed.

So learn to look for partners meet,  
Shun lofty things, nor raise your aims  
Above your fortune. Come then, sweet,  
My last of flames

(For never shall another fair  
Enslave me), learn a tune, to sing  
With that dear voice: to music care  
Shall yield its sting.

## XII. Iam veris comites, quae mare temperant

4.12

The gales of Thrace, that hush the unquiet sea,  
Spring's comrades, on the bellying canvas blow:  
Clogg'd earth and brawling streams alike are free

From winter's weight of snow.

Wailing her Itys in that sad, sad strain,  
Builds the poor bird, reproach to after time  
Of Cecrops' house, for bloody vengeance ta'en  
On foul barbaric crime.

The keepers of fat lambkins chant their loves  
To silvan reeds, all in the grassy lea,  
And pleasure Him who tends the flocks and groves  
Of dark-leaved Arcady.

It is a thirsty season, Virgil mine:  
But would you taste the grape's Calenian juice,  
Client of noble youths, to earn your wine  
Some nard you must produce.

A tiny box of nard shall bring to light  
The cask that in Sulpician cellar lies:  
O, it can give new hopes, so fresh and bright,  
And gladden gloomy eyes.

You take the bait? then come without delay  
And bring your ware: be sure, 'tis not my plan  
To let you drain my liquor and not pay,  
As might some wealthy man.

Come, quit those covetous thoughts, those knitted brows,  
Think on the last black embers, while you may,  
And be for once unwise. When time allows,  
'Tis sweet the fool to play.

## XIII. Audivere, Lyce, di mea vota, di

4.13

The gods have heard, the gods have heard my prayer;  
Yes, Lyce! you are growing old, and still  
You struggle to look fair;  
You drink, and dance, and trill

Your songs to youthful Love, in accents weak  
With wine, and age, and passion. Youthful Love!  
He dwells in Chia's cheek,  
And hears her harp-strings move.

Rude boy, he flies like lightning o'er the heath  
Past wither'd trees like you; you're wrinkled now;  
The white has left your teeth  
And settled on your brow.

Your Coan silks, your jewels bright as stars,  
Ah no! they bring not back the days of old,  
In public calendars  
By flying Time enroll'd.

Where now that beauty? where those movements? where  
That colour? what of her, of her is left,  
Who, breathing Love's own air,  
Me of myself bereft,

Who reign'd in Cinara's stead, a fair, fair face,  
Queen of sweet arts? but Fate to Cinara gave  
A life of little space;  
And now she cheats the grave

Of Lyce, spared to raven's length of days,

That youth may see, with laughter and disgust,  
A fire-brand, once ablaze,  
Now smouldering in grey dust.

#### XIV. Quae cura patrum quaeve Quiritium

4.14

What honours can a grateful Rome,  
A grateful senate, Caesar, give  
To make thy worth through days to come  
Emblazon'd on our records live,  
Mightiest of chieftains whomsoe'er  
The sun beholds from heaven on high?  
They know thee now, thy strength in war,  
Those unsubdued Vindelici.  
Thine was the sword that Drusus drew,  
When on the Breunian hordes he fell,  
And storm'd the fierce Genaunian crew  
E'en in their Alpine citadel,  
And paid them back their debt twice told;  
'Twas then the elder Nero came  
To conflict, and in ruin roll'd  
Stout Raetian kernes of giant frame.  
O, 'twas a gallant sight to see  
The shocks that beat upon the brave  
Who chose to perish and be free!  
As south winds scourge the rebel wave  
When through rent clouds the Pleiads weep,  
So keen his force to smite, and smite  
The foe, or make his charger leap  
Through the red furnace of the fight.  
Thus Daunia's ancient river fares,  
Proud Aufidus, with bull-like horn,  
When swoln with choler he prepares

A deluge for the fields of corn.  
So Claudius charged and overthrew  
The grim barbarian's mail-clad host,  
The foremost and the hindmost slew,  
And conquer'd all, and nothing lost.  
The force, the forethought, were thine own,  
Thine own the gods. The selfsame day  
When, port and palace open thrown,  
Low at thy footstool Egypt lay,  
That selfsame day, three lustres gone,  
Another victory to thine hand  
Was given; another field was won  
By grace of Caesar's high command.  
Thee Spanish tribes, unused to yield,  
Mede, Indian, Scyth that knows no home,  
Acknowledge, sword at once and shield  
Of Italy and queenly Rome.  
Ister to thee, and Tanais fleet,  
And Nile that will not tell his birth,  
To thee the monstrous seas that beat  
On Britain's coast, the end of earth,  
To thee the proud Iberians bow,  
And Gauls, that scorn from death to flee;  
The fierce Sygambrian bends his brow,  
And drops his arms to worship thee.

XV. Phoebus volentem proelia me loqui

4.15

Of battles fought I fain had told,  
And conquer'd towns, when Phoebus smote  
His harp-string: "Sooth, 'twere over-bold  
To tempt wide seas in that frail boat."  
Thy age, great Caesar, has restored

To squalid fields the plenteous grain,  
Given back to Rome's almighty Lord  
Our standards, torn from Parthian fane,  
Has closed Quirinian Janus' gate,  
Wild passion's erring walk controll'd,  
Heal'd the foul plague-spot of the state,  
And brought again the life of old,  
Life, by whose healthful power increased  
The glorious name of Latium spread  
To where the sun illumines the east  
From where he seeks his western bed.  
While Caesar rules, no civil strife  
Shall break our rest, nor violence rude,  
Nor rage, that whets the slaughtering knife  
And plunges wretched towns in feud.  
The sons of Danube shall not scorn  
The Julian edicts; no, nor they  
By Tanais' distant river born,  
Nor Persia, Scythia, or Cathay.  
And we on feast and working-tide,  
While Bacchus' bounties freely flow,  
Our wives and children at our side,  
First paying Heaven the prayers we owe,  
Shall sing of chiefs whose deeds are done,  
As wont our sires, to flute or shell,  
And Troy, Anchises, and the son  
Of Venus on our tongues shall dwell.

### The Secular Hymn

CS

Phoebus and Dian, huntress fair,  
To-day and always magnified,  
Bright lights of heaven, accord our prayer

This holy tide,

On which the Sibyl's volume wills  
That youths and maidens without stain  
To gods, who love the seven dear hills,  
Should chant the strain!

Sun, that unchanged, yet ever new,  
Lead'st out the day and bring'st it home,  
May nought be present to thy view  
More great than Rome!

Blest Ilithyia! be thou near  
In travail to each Roman dame!  
Lucina, Genitalis, hear,  
Whate'er thy name!

O make our youth to live and grow!  
The fathers' nuptial counsels speed,  
Those laws that shall on Rome bestow  
A plenteous seed!

So when a hundred years and ten  
Bring round the cycle, game and song  
Three days, three nights, shall charm again  
The festal throng.

Ye too, ye Fates, whose righteous doom,  
Declared but once, is sure as heaven,  
Link on new blessings, yet to come,  
To blessings given!

Let Earth, with grain and cattle rife,

Crown Ceres' brow with wreathen corn;  
Soft winds, sweet waters, nurse to life  
The newly born!

O lay thy shafts, Apollo, by!  
Let suppliant youths obtain thine ear!  
Thou Moon, fair "regent of the sky,"  
Thy maidens hear!

If Rome is yours, if Troy's remains,  
Safe by your conduct, sought and found  
Another city, other fanes  
On Tuscan ground,

For whom, 'mid fires and piles of slain,  
Aeneas made a broad highway,  
Destined, pure heart, with greater gain  
Their loss to pay,

Grant to our sons unblemish'd ways;  
Grant to our sires an age of peace;  
Grant to our nation power and praise,  
And large increase!

See, at your shrine, with victims white,  
Prays Venus and Anchises' heir!  
O prompt him still the foe to smite,  
The fallen to spare!

Now Media dreads our Alban steel,  
Our victories land and ocean o'er;  
Scythia and Ind in suppliance kneel,  
So proud before.

Faith, Honour, ancient Modesty,  
And Peace, and Virtue, spite of scorn,  
Come back to earth; and Plenty, see,  
With teeming horn.

Augur and lord of silver bow,  
Apollo, darling of the Nine,  
Who heal'st our frame when languors slow  
Have made it pine;

Lov'st thou thine own Palatial hill,  
Prolong the glorious life of Rome  
To other cycles, brightening still  
Through time to come!

From Algidus and Aventine  
List, goddess, to our grave Fifteen!  
To praying youths thine ear incline,  
Diana queen!

Thus Jove and all the gods agree!  
So trusting, wend we home again,  
Phoebus and Dian's singers we,  
And this our strain.